



Nature(s) in Narrative

Reykjavík

Full Programme

Conference Timetable

Friday 12 June

17:00-19:00 **ISFNR Executive committee's meeting (closed)**

Saturday 13 June

10:00-17:00 **Museums with free admission June 13th-16th upon showing the conference badge**

10:00-17:00 **Museum visits**

10:15-11:15 **A guided tour through the National Museum of Iceland**

11:00-16:00 **Registration Desk open**

11:00-16:00 **University Centre**

13:15-15:00 **Panel Session 1**

P06 (1/3) Wild witness world. Narratives about 'unusual encounters' between human and wild non-human animals [A-311]

P10 (1/2) Strange things happen at sea [O-202]

P14 (1/2) Non human, human, and inhumane nature and natures in fairy tales and wonder media [O-201]

P16 (1/2) Nature in materiality and digital narratives [A-201]

P17 (1/2) Narrating “the normal” and “the natural” in a catastrophic world [A-304]

P18 (1/2) Natural forces in Slavic folk narratives [V-007]

P20 (1/2) Narrative ecologies: folklore, fiction, and cultural response to climate change [A-301]

P29 (1/2) Narrating nature in times of war [A-303]

P30 The nature(s) of enchantment and disenchantment: Moon – Sun pendulums in narrative traditions [A-306]

P34 (1/2) New animism and other than human life forms in belief narratives: agency, personhood, interactions [O-101]

P37 Nature(s) in the ritual narratives and practices of Southwest China [O-106]

P47 (1/2) Risking it all: disaster narratives, identity, and fierce nature [O-206]

P48 (1/2) Nature and its limits [A-309]

15:00-15:30 **Coffee break**

15:30-17:15 **Panel Session 2**

P06 (2/3) Wild witness world. Narratives about 'unusual encounters' between human and wild non-human animals [A-311]

P10 (2/2) Strange things happen at sea [O-202]

P13 (1/3) Natures in narratives and cultures of creatures: exploring naturecultures of the supernatural [A-306]

P14 (2/2) Non human, human, and inhumane nature and natures in fairy tales and wonder media [O-201]

P16 (2/2) Nature in materiality and digital narratives [A-201]

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P34 (2/2) New animism and other than human life forms in belief narratives: agency, personhood, interactions [O-101]

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P48 (2/2) Nature and its limits [A-309]

18:00-20:30 **Conference opening (in person only)**

18:00-20:30 **Reykjavík Maritime Museum, Grandagarður 8**

20:00-21:00 **Discount codes for Tours and Excursions**

Sunday 14 June

09:00-10:45 **Panel session 3**

P02 (1/3) Between worlds: narratives of the living and the dead through natural environment and spatiality [A-201]

P06 (3/3) Wild witness world. Narratives about 'unusual encounters' between human and wild non-human animals [A-311]

P09 (1/2) Usable narratives: the lives of stories in the age of eroding truth [A-309]

P13 (2/3) Natures in narratives and cultures of creatures: exploring naturecultures of the supernatural [A-306]

P23 (1/2) Healing landscapes and reshaped geography in wartime narratives [V-007]

P32 (1/2) Earth, wind and fire: narrating the elemental in the Anthropocene [A-301]

P41 Beyond the supernatural [O-202]

P45 Transformations of narrative knowledge in the Arctic and sub-Arctic, and the ongoing degradation of sentient landscapes in the North [O-206]

P52 (1/2) Talking tables: food, stories, and social encounters [A-303]

P58 (1/2) Exploring digitalised folkloric youth political activism in new geographies of the global South [A-304]

P64 Nature, gender, and love [O-201]

P65 Post-conflicts [O-106]

10:00-17:00 **Museums with free admission June 13th-16th upon showing the conference badge**

10:00-17:00 **Museum visits**

10:45-11:15 **Coffee break**

11:15-13:00 **Panel Session 4**

P02 (2/3) Between worlds: narratives of the living and the dead through natural environment and spatiality [A-201]

P09 (2/2) Usable narratives: the lives of stories in the age of eroding truth [A-309]

P13 (3/3) Natures in narratives and cultures of creatures: exploring naturecultures of the supernatural [A-306]

P23 (2/2) Healing landscapes and reshaped geography in wartime narratives [V-007]

P24 From oceans to outer space: cultural cosmologies across contemporary narratives [O-106]

P26 (1/2) Revisiting oicotypes: cultural ecologies and disciplinary boundaries [O-206]

P32 (2/2) Earth, wind and fire: narrating the elemental in the Anthropocene [A-301]

P43 Boundaries and crossings in Asian folk narratives of the “natural” environment [O-201]

P50 Eco-possession: Divining natural environments [O-202]

P51 (1/2) “Our” natures, “their” natures: How contemporary legend delineates, defines, and describes us [A-311]

P52 (2/2) Talking tables: food, stories, and social encounters [A-303]

P58 (2/2) Exploring digitalised folkloric youth political activism in new geographies of the global South [A-304]

13:00-14:30	Lunch
13:15-14:15	Narrative Culture - Meet the Editors
13:15-14:15	A-201
13:30-14:15	Committee and Working Group Meetings
14:30-15:30	Keynote: Tina Paphitis, University of Bergen
14:30-15:30	Háskólabíó
15:30-16:00	Coffee break
16:00-17:45	Panel Session 5
P01 More than repositories: archives as narrative landscapes of nature and culture [A-301] P23B (Workshop)Nature(s) in Narrative: Memory, Home, and Environment in Storytelling [O-101] P25 (1/2) Exploring the roles of econarratives in the (re)negotiation of identity [A-306] P26 (2/2) Revisiting oicotypes: cultural ecologies and disciplinary boundaries [O-206] P46 Listening for (un)natural contexts in audio recordings of folk narratives [O-202] P51 (2/2) “Our” natures, “their” natures: How contemporary legend delineates, defines, and describes us [A-311] P55 Southern Gothic forms in literature of the Celtic and Nordic peripheries [A-201] P61 Plants and Gardens [O-201] P68 Urban landscape and transdisciplinary econarratives [A-309]	
20:00-21:00	Discount codes for Tours and Excursions

Monday 15 June

09:00-10:45	Panel Session 6
P02 (1/3) Between worlds: narratives of the living and the dead through natural environment and spatiality [A-201] P11 (1/2) Fairy-tale ecologies: forests and the nonhuman in narrative imagination [O-201] P12 (1/2) Moving stories? Emergent narratives in walks through nature(s) [O-202] P19 (1/2) Monstrous landscapes [A-303] P21 (1/2) Between concrete and clover: nature in urban storytelling [A-309] P25 (2/2) Exploring the roles of econarratives in the (re)negotiation of identity [A-306] P31 (1/2) Nature as subject and symbol: ecological perspectives in folk song traditions [O-101] P33 (1/2) (Co)narrating nature in a written form [O-206] P36 (1/2) Regenerative narratives: (eco)feminist entanglements with nature [A-304] P42 (1/2) Lives with(out) nature? Representations and narratives of (lost) rural worlds [V-008] P44 (1/2) Mythical nature(s) and narrative transformations across the North Atlantic [A-301] P49 (1/2) Roots and voices: exploring nature, identity, and the sacred in oral narratives from indigenous communities across cultures and continents. [O-106] P70 (1/2) Folk fears and nature’s fury - fictions, film, flora, and fauna [V-007] P72 Folk song and music [A-311]	

10:00-17:00	Museums with free admission June 13th-16th upon showing the conference badge
10:00-17:00	Museum visits
10:45-11:15	Coffee break
11:15-13:00	Panel Session 7
	P11 (2/2) Fairy-tale ecologies: forests and the nonhuman in narrative imagination [O-201] P12 (2/2) Moving stories? Emergent narratives in walks through nature(s) [O-202] P19 (2/2) Monstrous landscapes [A-303] P21 (2/2) Between concrete and clover: nature in urban storytelling [A-309] P31 (2/2) Nature as subject and symbol: ecological perspectives in folk song traditions [O-101] P33 (2/2) (Co)narrating nature in a written form [O-206] P36 (2/2) Regenerative narratives: (eco)feminist entanglements with nature [A-304] P42 (2/2) Lives with(out) nature? Representations and narratives of (lost) rural worlds [V-008] P44 (2/2) Mythical nature(s) and narrative transformations across the North Atlantic [A-301] P49 (2/2) Roots and voices: exploring nature, identity, and the sacred in oral narratives from indigenous communities across cultures and continents. [O-106] P69 Personal narratives [A-201] P70 (2/2) Folk fears and nature's fury - fictions, film, flora, and fauna [V-007]
13:00-14:15	Lunch
13:00-14:15	Poster Session (in person only)
13:00-14:15	University Centre
14:15-15:30	ISFNR Annual Meeting
14:15-15:30	Háskólabíó
15:30-16:30	Keynote: Sjón (novelist and screenwriter), Rósa Þorsteinsdóttir (Árni Magnússon Institute for Icelandic Studies), and Ragnheiður Vignisdóttir (National Gallery of Iceland)
15:30-16:30	Háskólabíó
16:30-20:30	Cultural programme
17:00-19:30	Cultural Programme 2 - Edda manuscript exhibition, traditional music and dance (in person)
17:00-19:30	Edda building, Arngrímsgata 5
17:00-20:00	Cultural programme 3 - Shore walking and (optional) bathing at Nauthólsvík Geothermal Beach (in person)
17:30-19:30	Cultural Programme 1 - Viðey Island flora tour (in person)

17:30-19:30 Ægisgarður

20:00-21:00 Discount codes for Tours and Excursions

Tuesday 16 June

09:00-10:45 Panel Session 8

- P04 (1/2)** Climate and weather narratives in the past [A-303]
P05 Challenging dichotomies: the marvelous in nature and the nature of the marvelous in folk narrative [O-206]
P07 (1/2) Nature as trope in strategic brand communications [O-201]
P08 (1/3) Nature in short folklore forms [A-306]
P15 (1/2) Haunted landscapes: landforms and water bodies from a geo-folklore perspective [O-106]
P22 (1/2) Entangled heritage, nature and identity: transdisciplinary perspectives to storytelling [A-201]
P28 (1/2) Archived nature [O-202]
P35 (1/3) Enchanted landscapes guiding human-nature interactions [O-101]
P38 (1/2) Intersections of nature and the supernatural in story worlds of Eastern Asia [A-311]
P39 (1/3) Ritual narratives: animals and plants in ritual contexts [A-304]
P40 (1/2) Reimagining plant-human entanglements through multimodal approaches [A-301]
P73 Animal-human relations [A-309]
P74 (1/2) Landscapes [V-007]

10:00-17:00 Museum visits

10:00-17:00 Museums with free admission June 13th-16th upon showing the conference badge

10:45-11:15 Coffee break

11:15-13:00 Panel Session 9

- P03 (1/2)** Climate change, gender and nature: narratives of survival, resilience and resistance storytelling, ritual, and ecological memory in Indigenous and gendered contexts [A-309]
P04 (2/2) Climate and weather narratives in the past [A-303]
P07 (2/2) Nature as trope in strategic brand communications [O-201]
P08 (2/3) Nature in short folklore forms [A-306]
P15 (2/2) Haunted landscapes: landforms and water bodies from a geo-folklore perspective [O-106]
P22 (2/2) Entangled heritage, nature and identity: transdisciplinary perspectives to storytelling [A-201]
P28 (2/2) Archived nature [O-202]
P35 (2/3) Enchanted landscapes guiding human-nature interactions [O-101]
P38 (2/2) Intersections of nature and the supernatural in story worlds of Eastern Asia [A-311]
P39 (2/3) Ritual narratives: animals and plants in ritual contexts [A-304]
P40 (2/2) Reimagining plant-human entanglements through multimodal approaches [A-301]
P71 (1/2) Sacred spaces [O-206]
P74 (2/2) Landscapes [V-007]

13:00-14:30 Lunch

13:00-14:15 ISFNR Executive committee's meeting (closed)

13:00-14:15	V-008
14:30-15:30	Keynote: Frog, University of Helsinki
14:30-15:30	Háskólabíó
15:30-16:15	Coffee break
15:45-16:15	Working Group and Committee Info Points
15:45-16:15	University Centre
16:15-18:00	Panel Session 10
P03 (2/2) Climate change, gender and nature: narratives of survival, resilience and resistance storytelling, ritual, and ecological memory in Indigenous and gendered contexts [A-309] P08 (3/3) Nature in short folklore forms [A-306] P27 Narrating nature, performing identity: Ukrainian folklore in domestic, digital, and diasporic worlds [O-106] P35 (3/3) Enchanted landscapes guiding human-nature interactions [O-101] P39 (3/3) Ritual narratives: animals and plants in ritual contexts [A-304] P62 Media and Senses [O-201] P63 Supernatural Beings [A-311] P66 Technology – old and new [O-202] P71 (2/2) Sacred spaces [O-206]	
19:30-23:30	Conference Closing event (in person only)
19:30-23:30	Hafnarhús, Tryggvagata 17
20:00-21:00	Discount codes for Tours and Excursions

Panels and Papers

P01 · A-301

More than repositories: archives as narrative landscapes of nature and culture Panel

A-301: Sun 14 Jun 16:00-17:45

Convenors: Miss Maria Isabel Lemos (IELT - Universidade Nova de Lisboa); Dr Hubert Wierciński (University of Warsaw)

This panel explores archives as narrative landscapes where nature and culture converge. It investigates how archival forms, practices, and materials are shaped by stories; folk, environmental, and digital, revealing archives as dynamic, living systems.

Roles of Indigenous Knowledge and Folk Narratives in Human-Wildlife Conflict Management

Mr Okechukwu Iroegbu (University of California Los Angeles)

This paper explores the role of indigenous knowledge in managing human-wildlife conflict, focusing on land's significance. Drawing on Igbo traditions and personal experience, it shows how African folk narratives can guide more harmonious human-nature relationships.

An ethnographer searches the archives: Polish polar expeditions to Svalbard in 1950-1960 and the experience of the Arctic landscape

Dr Hubert Wierciński (University of Warsaw)

In the 1950s Polish explorers returned to Svalbard. Searching through preserved archives, I examine the narratives about relationships with the Arctic landscape. I investigate the relationships they established with the landscape and examine the skills and knowledge they developed in this process.

The Oral Folk Narrative as a Narrative Map

Dr Kathleen Ragan (Independent Scholar)

Indigenous folktales of Australia & North American include detailed, accurate, environmental information like narrative maps that can be used in wayfinding, the location of resources, and to broaden the geographic outlook. Folktales are seen as a scaffold on which information can be memorably hung.

Historicising ecological crises in Cape Verde: mapping oral testimonies across archives and fieldwork

Miss Maria Isabel Lemos (IELT - Universidade Nova de Lisboa)

This ethnographic study examines localised narratives of drought and environmental vulnerability in Cape Verde. Drawing on the Oral Traditions Archive and fieldwork, it explores how communities historicise ecological crises and the potential roles of the archive in these discursive processes.

"Digitizing Nature: Revealing Ecological Narratives in the Hannaas Collection"

Ms Angun Sønnesyn Olsen (University of Bergen)

This paper explores ecological relationships and vernacular epistemologies in the Hannaas Collection. It explores the ways in which folklore preserves environmental knowledge and how digitization can recover this knowledge, often obscured by archival structures.

P02 · A-201

Between worlds: narratives of the living and the dead through natural environment and spatiality Panel

A-201: Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00, Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45

Convenors: Dr Tatiana Bužeková (Faculty of Arts, Comenius University in Bratislava); Prof Mirjam Mencej (Faculty of Arts, University of Ljubljana)

The panel focuses on how the connection between the living and the dead is reflected in various types of narratives in relation to natural environment and spatiality. Subjects for discussion include morality, individual and collective identity, social changes, memory, and storytelling.

Narrated deathscapes in traditional folk legends and contemporary thinking

Dr Kaarina Koski (University of Turku)

In my paper, I explore how Finnish traditional belief legends delineated deathscapes and emphasised the danger of places belonging to the dead. I analyse the pursuit to keep the dead and the living strictly apart and briefly compare it with the more porous deathscapes of our time.

The dead as agents of (changing) morality in the context of changing spatial and social practices in Bosnian Muslim rural communities

Prof Mirjam Mencej (Faculty of Arts, University of Ljubljana)

This paper compares ghost narratives in rural Bosnia before and after the war, arguing that since the war new categories of the dead and new sites for their agentive power have emerged, reflecting changing spatial and social practices, with the dead participating as agents of (changing) morality.

Encounters with the Unknown Dead in Rural Northeastern Slovenia

Mrs Simona Kuntarič Zupanc (University of Ljubljana)

Ethnographic accounts from northeastern Slovenia describe encounters with unknown dead in forests and borderlands. Sudden stillness, unusual sounds, and environmental shifts trigger a sensed presence that shapes local moral geographies and perceptions of danger and place.

Other-than-natural Experiences and the Natural Order of Explanations

Dr Kirsten Marie Raahauge (The Royal Danish Academy of Architecture, Design and Conservation, The Design School)

With disappointing results many of my Danish interviewees attempt to understand their strange experiences through rationality and logic, furthermore the Danish land- and cityscape is highly domesticated and spatially out of sync with such sensations which might add to the difficulties.

P03 · A-309

Climate change, gender and nature: narratives of survival, resilience and resistance storytelling, ritual, and ecological memory in Indigenous and gendered contexts Panel

A-309: Tue 16 Jun 11:15-13:00, 16:15-18:00

Convenors: Dr Annapurna Devi Pandey (UCSC)

Discussant: Dr Annapurna Devi Pandey (UCSC)

This panel will explore the intersection of climate change, gender, and nature through the lens of folk narratives, oral traditions, rituals, and ecology. How do women experience ecological loss or resilience? What roles do folk narratives play in community responses to climate change?

Livelihoods of Tribal or Adivasi Communities in the Drought Prone Areas: An Ethnographic Study from Andhra Pradesh

Dr Eswarappa Kasi (Indira Gandhi National Tribal University)

The paper aims to look at the existing livelihoods in the drought-prone region of Andhra Pradesh. The drought is due to the changing nature of climatic behavior prevailing in the area, and thus further led to large-scale migration of the poor and vulnerable tribal communities to the towns.

Threads of Sustainability: Gendered Traditions and Nature-Culture Stories Among North Indian Women

Ms Yashasvi Chaurasia (Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi)

This ethnographic study examines how older women's narratives in North Indian rural communities reveal vanishing zero-waste practices and environmental knowledge, exposing gendered dimensions of sustainability transmission and resistance to plastic modernity.

From Jataka Tales to Igbo Rituals and Tsavo Legends: Folklore as a Framework for Ecological Ethics

Mr Okechukwu Iroegbu (University of California Los Angeles)

This paper explores folklore as a framework for ecological ethics through Jataka tales, Igbo rituals, and Tsavo legends. These stories reveal values of kinship, stewardship, and spiritual ecology, offering culturally rooted insights for sustainable living and environmental justice today.

The Voices of Resilience to Heal a Diseased Gaia: An Ecofeminist Reading of Terry Tempest Williams's Refuge: An Unnatural History of Family and Place

Dr Jagriti Upadhyaya (Jai Narain Vyas University); Dr Manorama Upadhyaya (Jai Narain Vyas University)

P04 · A-303

Climate and weather narratives in the past Panel

A-303: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Mrs Lotta Leiwo (University of Helsinki); Mr Eiríkur Valdimarsson (Research Centre Strandir - The Folklore Institute)

This panel examines historical climate and weather narratives to reveal cultural attitudes and practices, informing current climate responses. It invites papers on vernacular expressions, mediums, and formats used to convey these narratives, aiming to deepen understanding of nature and weatherlore.

Folk narratives as a source for the history of extreme climatic events: the 'Great Winter of 1709' in Brittany (Western France)

Dr Eva Guillourel (Université Rennes 2)

Oral traditions in the Breton language (Western France) rarely mention extreme weather events. The references to the 'Great Winter of 1709' are an exception. This case invites us to analyse the unequal contribution of different folk genres to the study of climate narratives in the past.

Ways to Control Atmospheric Phenomena Through Magic in Lithuanian Mythology

Mrs Radvilė Racėnaitė (The Institute of Lithuanian Literature and Folklore)

The paper explores Lithuanian meteorological and agricultural magic and the ways it was employed to communicate with mythical beings believed to be responsible for the atmospheric phenomena and harvest.

Hai-i-Alun: The Ballad Narrating the Birth of the Weather Goddess among the Karbis a Community Living in Assam. (It reveals the cultural attitude and the practice of rainmaking of the Karbis.)

Prof Dilip Kumar Kalita (Retired Professor); Dr Parismita Sarma (Baihata Chariali B.Ed College, Assam, India)

Hai-i-Alun is a Ballad narrating the birth of the Weather Goddess among the Karbis, a community living in Assam, the northeastern state of India. Although the ballad is the story of common people in the historic past, it has become a sacred part of the Karbi belief system.

Icelandic Weather Folklore, in Past and Present (and Future?)

Mr Eiríkur Valdimarsson (Research Centre Strandir - The Folklore Institute)

The lecture explores the significance of weather and the understanding of its progression for Icelanders throughout the centuries. It examines various traditional methods of weather prediction, how this skill has evolved over generations, and the impact of climate change on such folkloric knowledge.

P05 · O-206

Challenging dichotomies: the marvelous in nature and the nature of the marvelous in folk narrative Panel

O-206: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45

Convenors: Dr Margaret Lyngdoh (University of Tartu)

This panel explores how folk narratives across cultures challenge binary distinctions between nature and culture through representations of the Marvelous, hybrid beings, enchanted spaces, and transformative encounters with non-human entities.

Nature as a living entity in the traditional Tibetan opera tales

Ms Judit Katalin Hollos (Eotvos Lorand University)

"Nature as a living entity in the traditional Tibetan opera tales" explores the relevance of a living nature and its magical creatures in the traditional Tibetan opera tales and how it shapes Tibetan folk tale tradition and the rich cultural heritage the genre of Ache Lhamo carries in modern times.

Marvelous Materialities: Sari-Draping and Other-than-Human Agency

Ms Linda Saraswati Klausner (University of Tartu)

This paper examines how sari-draping of trees and plants animates other-than-human agency, creates enchanted spaces, and affords marginalized women vernacular authority. Drawing on Santali and Hindu seasonal festivals, it explores ritual ecologies that challenge nature/culture binaries.

Dreams, Landscapes, and Punishments: Affective Folkloristics of Belief and Other-than-Human Entanglements in Northeast Indian Landscapes

Mr Abhirup Sarkar (University of Tartu)

This paper examines the Karbi concept of parallel reality and the associated narratives that highlight a non-binary association and interplay between dream worlds, agency of nature, and human intentionalities, through the analysis

of ethnographic fieldwork materials from Karbi Anglong.

Multiple Realities among Indigenous Communities of Northeast India as Mediated through Magical Traditions

Dr Margaret Lyngdoh (University of Tartu)

My presentation will bring perspectives from fieldwork and I will show how magical traditions mediate parallel realities. I try to look at general ritual practice and try to elucidate the base rationale behind magic among Khasi and Karbi as facilitatory and how reality can be blurred.

P06 · A-311

Wild witness world. Narratives about 'unusual encounters' between human and wild non-human animals Panel

A-311: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15, Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45

Convenors: Dr Malay Bera (University of Tartu); Prof Sadhana Naithani (Jawaharlal Nehru University)

This panel proposes to discuss fictional and non-fictional folk and popular narratives concerning 'unusual encounters' between human and wild non-human animals and explore the roles folk and popular narratives in oral, print or digital media play in making, unmaking and remaking ecological concerns.

When a Bear Comes into the City: A Case in Lithuanian Media

Dr Lina Būgienė (Institute of Lithuanian Literature and Folklore)

In June 2025, a wild bear was spotted in the residential areas of Vilnius, causing considerable commotion among residents and an outburst of interest in the media and social networks. This paper dwells on various interpretations of this encounter and their explicit or implicit meanings.

Bears, Scottish Gaels and their Encounters

Dr John William Shaw (University of Edinburgh)

An examination of the special role of bears in the consciousness of Scottish Gaels from early times to the present despite having become extinct in Scotland. Particular attention will be paid to their active re-emergence in the oral traditions of 19th century diaspora communities in Canada.

Human-Hunman Encounters: Negotiating Sacred Space, Sacrifice, and the Edges of the Wild

Dr Malay Bera (University of Tartu)

Examining narratives of encounters between human and hunman (gray langur) in Bengal, this paper explores how these wild animals negotiate sacred, domestic, and ritual spaces while interacting with humans and shaping narratives of religiosity, wilderness, power, and interspecies coexistence.

P07 · O-201

Nature as trope in strategic brand communications Panel

O-201: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Szilvia Gyimóthy (Copenhagen Business School); Dr Hanne Pico Larsen (Tuck School of Business); Dr Susanne Österlund-Pötzsch (Society of Swedish Literature in Finland)

How do notions of nature relate to narrations of identity, heritage, the national and personal, the physical and the spiritual? We zoom in on brand promotional material from fashion and tourism contexts and ponder the allure and marketization of nature in corporate storytelling.

When Nature Speaks Back: Branding Iceland through the Blue Lagoon

Prof Valdimar Tr. Hafstein (University of Iceland)

The Blue Lagoon brands geothermal waters as soothing, pure, iconic. Yet the volcanic forces that give it life also close its gates. This paper explores lagoon branding as a dialogic genre: nature staged in mineral tranquility, and nature speaking back with fire, brimstone, and noxious gases.

The Turquoise Gaze: Sensory Aesthetics and the Reclamation Narrative in Konin's Tourism

Mr Hubert Tubacki (Adam Mickiewicz University)

This paper explores how Konin, a Polish post-mining region, turns industrial scars like its "Turquoise Lakes" into tourist assets. This reclamation narrative offers a compelling tourism model for the Anthropocene, moving beyond the classic "man vs. nature" conflict

Forest Bathing or Rural Living? Nature as Sensory Experience and Luxury Commodity in Valchiusella

Miss Amalia Campagna (University of Milan); Dr Roberta Clara Zanini (University of Turin)

In Valchiusella, holistic practitioners offer “forest bathing” to urban tourists seeking authenticity. But what happens when nature, lived daily by farmers, becomes a luxury experience? An ethnographic study on nature as a sensory and symbolic good.

Branding the travelling self through images of nature

Ms Rebecca Campbell (KU Leuven); Prof Paolo S. H. Favero (University of Antwerp)

Building on ethnographic material from Mafia Island (Tanzania) and Bali (Indonesia) we look at travel influencers as contemporary iterations of brands. Focussing on the affective impact of images we address the packaging of the enchantment of nature for the promotion of the travelling self.

P08 · A-306

Nature in short folklore forms Panel

A-306: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00, 16:15-18:00

Convenors: Dr Saša Babič (Research Centre of Slovenian Academy of Sciences and Arts); Dr Tiber Falzett (University College Dublin); Dr Nataša Jakop (ZRC SAZU)

Chair: Dr Saša Babič (Research Centre of Slovenian Academy of Sciences and Arts); Dr Tiber Falzett (University College Dublin); Dr Nataša Jakop (ZRC SAZU)

Short folklore forms are all tightly connected to everyday life of the society. These forms mirror in a compressed message the conceptualisations of to everyday, including the natural world, its observation, or even its utilisation for economic activity, like harvesting and livestock.

The Animal World in Common European Proverbs.

Dr Fionnuala Carson Williams (Independent Researcher)

Globally birds and beasts are familiar in proverbs. My paper explores those in a classic corpus of 100 common European proverbs. The fauna include both domestic and wild as well as exotic. In some proverbs the animals vary from language to language. The corpus includes the odd Universal proverb.

Domestic animals as motifs in proverbs, unconventional phraseological replies and incantations

Dr Matej Meterc (Research Centre of the Slovenian Academy of Sciences and Arts); Mr Rok Mrvič (ZRC SAZU)

By analyzing zoonymic motifs in Slovenian proverbs, unconventional phraseological replies, and incantations, while considering the genre characteristics of these short folklore forms, we aim to reveal the roles and values of domestic animals in everyday human life.

Animals in Short Tales and Popular Sayings: Insights from Transylvanian Folklore

Dr Alina Ioana Branda (Babes-Bolyai University)

This paper explores the symbolic role of animals in the short tales and proverbial wisdom of Transylvania, a region at the crossroads of Central and Eastern Europe, drawing upon Romanian, Hungarian, and Saxon (German) traditions preserved in the area.

From Mud to Table: A Tale of a Pig's Value in Slovenian Proverbial Tradition

Mr Rok Mrvič (ZRC SAZU); Dr Saša Poljak Istenič (ZRC SAZU)

The paper explores human evaluations of pigs and the values attached to them in Slovenian proverbs. It identifies two dimensions: the pig as a living animal in daily life and as a symbolic figure of human character, reflecting the broader human relationship with nature.

P09 · A-309

Usable narratives: the lives of stories in the age of eroding truth Panel

A-309: Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Prof Regina F. Bendix (Georg-August-Universität Göttingen)

Who uses narratives for what in the present moment? How do narratives illuminate mechanisms of power, conflict and violence directed to humans, nature, the planet? Inviting case studies and theoretical papers, we will investigate the post-truth paradigm to produce energy and hope for social change.

Nature and narratives of climate change denial. Nostalgia and dystopian imaginaries

Ms Caroline Reinhammar (University of Gothenburg)

Digital narratives of climate change denial express a longing for a “natural order,” where humans did not shape the climate yet remained subject to its power. Using Svetlana Boym's concepts on nostalgia, this paper reflect on how such imaginaries of nature function to structure denialist discourse

Folklore of Expertise: Water Narratives, Local Knowledge, and Ecological Hope

Prof Agata Stanis (Adam Mickiewicz University in Poznań)

I capture the scientific discourse on water as a form of folklore, characterized by its intertwining with local knowledge, and its evolution into narratives of care, resistance and responsibility in the post-truth era. These narratives influence ecological imagination, solidarity and community action

Between Linguistic Truth and the Israeli Spatial Imaginary: Arabic Place Names in Israeli Society

Dr Amer Dahamshe ()

The lecture explores how Arabic place names persist in Israel despite Hebraization, revealing tensions between Palestinian memory, the Zionist "empty land" narrative, and Jewish theological claims to the land.

Carbon Capture Confabulations: The Trees Promised Nothing

Dr Evander Price (The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen)

Folk stories are rife with narratives of the regenerative powers of trees. So too are IPCC carbon capture narratives. The Anthropocene has proven these narratives to be increasingly naïve, if not detrimental, to facing the necessary challenges of climate apocalypse.

P10 · O-202

Strange things happen at sea Panel

O-202: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15

Convenors: Prof Shelley Ingram (University of Louisiana at Lafayette); Dr Audun Kjus (Norsk Folkemuseum (The Norwegian Museum of Cultural History)); Dr Willow Mullins (University of Edinburgh); Dr Cliona O'Carroll (University College Cork)

The sea carries hardship and abundance, sometimes over unfathomed depths and against uncharted horizons, serving as a constantly shifting mirror of the human situation. In this panel, we explore narratives of encounter and exchange in the zones of sea and shore.

Contemporary Creation Stories: Creation/Destruction Where Sea Meets Shore

Prof Shelley Ingram (University of Louisiana at Lafayette); Dr Willow Mullins (University of Edinburgh)

In two college classrooms an ocean apart, students are given a task. After studying a variety of creation myths, they are asked to compose their own story. The results reveal how narrative continues to insist on the cosmological power of the sea to shape communities for better or worse.

Waterpeople - motif, genre and meaning

Dr Audun Kjus (Norsk Folkemuseum (The Norwegian Museum of Cultural History))

Merfolk are complex beings. After introducing Reidar Christiansen's exposition of the motifs of the Nordic merpeople legends, I will present some of the different kinds of merpersons that may be encountered and add a few ponderings on how they are communicated and what their messages signify.

Strange Encounters in Mermaiding -Swimming with Mermaids and Ocean Beings

Mrs Jasmine Aavaranta (Åbo Akademi University)

Mermaiding is a growing cultural phenomenon of extreme freediving while wearing mermaid tails. This paper explores how practitioners journey across the globe to swim as something other-than-human, encountering whale sharks, seals, and other ocean beings in adventures that blur myth and lived reality.

P11 · O-201

Fairy-tale ecologies: forests and the nonhuman in narrative imagination

O-201: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Pablo a Marca (Brown University); Dr Julie Koehler (Michigan State University); Prof Lewis Seifert (Brown University); Dr Juliane Wuensch (Skidmore College)

[FNLM]

This panel explores ecological entanglements in fairy tales, with special focus on forests and the nonhuman. It examines how narrative forms across time and place reflect shifting conceptions of nature, land, and nonhuman agency.

The Forest in Folk Narratives: Between Nature and Culture

Mrs Anastasia Floraki (Democritus University of Thrace)

This paper examines the forest in Greek folk tales, especially from Tinos, as a space where human and nonhuman worlds meet. It highlights the forest as an active narrative force, entangling nature, culture, and ecology in folk imagination.

Damsels in the Woods: Nonhuman Agency and Ecological Entanglements in 17th-Century French Women's Fairy Tales.

Dr Sophie Raynard (Stony Brook University); Dr Charlotte Trinquet du Lys (UCF)

17th C. French women's fairy tales view the forest and nonhuman agents as vital, autonomous actors, not just backdrops. This ecological consciousness promotes symbiosis, revealing that moral virtue is tied to nature, and nonhuman aid is key to heroines' proto-feminist empowerment.

D'Aulnoy's Forests and the Nature/Culture Divide

Prof Lewis Seifert (Brown University)

This paper will explore how representations of forests in d'Aulnoy's fairy tales reflect the neo-classical ideal of nature perfected by culture but also approximate Donna Haraway's notion of "natureculture," the recognition that nature and culture are intertwined and mutually constitutive.

Forests and Sprites in the tales by Amalia Schoppe

Dr Juliane Wuensch (Skidmore College)

This paper uses ecofeminism to analyze the occurrences and different functions of the forest and its magical creatures in Amalia Schoppe's tale collection. The primary focus is on how the protagonist engages with the natural setting and its inhabitants and how these encounters change their life.

P12 · O-202

Moving stories? Emergent narratives in walks through nature(s) Panel

O-202: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Susanne Österlund-Pötzsch (Society of Swedish Literature in Finland)

Chair: Dr Camilla Brudin Borg (One by walking, The University of Gothenburg)

Wandering entails a close and intense physical engagement with the environment – to what degree is nature an actor in walking narratives, and in which ways do narratives emerge from the relationship between walker and her physical and natural surroundings.

Creek Walk Worldmaking

Dr Katherine Borland (Ohio State University, Columbus)

Ambulatory storytelling provides an alternative model to the fireside or stage. Using the World Plowing Match story from tiny Peebles, Ohio, I explore intersubjective dimensions of stories that emerge while walking and talking to challenge orthodoxies around story form, ownership, and historicity.

Walking with Bears: Multispecies Encounters and the Storying of Landscape

Dr Maja Pasarić (Institute of Ethnology and Folklore Research)

This paper explores how walking in bear-inhabited landscapes in Croatia, becomes a multispecies, affective, and ethical practice—revealing how humans and brown bears co-create meaningful landscapes through stories, sensory experiences, and shared presence.

Reading While Walking: Pilgrimage, Geological Time, and the More-than-Human Narrative

Dr Camilla Brudin Borg (One by walking, The University of Gothenburg)

Walking Camino del Norte—zooming in on geological textures, zooming out to deep time—is a reading that discloses and illuminates nature's agency through multiscalar readings. Mythical, historical, and ecological layers converge, making walking a narrative practice entangled with the more-than-human.

P13 · A-306

Natures in narratives and cultures of creatures: exploring naturecultures of the supernatural Panel

A-306: Sat 13 Jun 15:30-17:15, Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Other Line Esborg (University of Oslo); Prof Kyrre Kverndokk (University of Bergen); Ms Ane Ohrvik (University of Oslo); Dr Tina Paphitis (University of Bergen)

This panel takes an empirical look at supernatural beings in international folk narratives in archives, collections, and publications from 1600 to the present. It seeks to challenge simple conceptions of nature through interrogations of supernatural naturecultures and more-than-human entanglements.

(Super)natural driftage: the nature-culture of Iceland's fjords and shores

Dr Kristinn Schram (University of Iceland)

The natureculture entanglements of Iceland's fjords and shores are discussed here, focusing on the non-human actants present in legends. It explores how folk narratives centring on flora, fauna and nature-cultural material, themselves question ontological assumptions and established boundaries.

Isle Be Gone: Vanishing Islands in Norse and Celtic Traditions

Dr Felix Lummer (University of Iceland)

This lecture will consider how the vanishing islands of the North Sea area represent supernatural naturecultures, negotiating thresholds of human maritime subsistence and nautical fears, which stand in stark contrast to Irish insular paradises and the Old Norse Glasisvellir.

Lady of the forest or ghost of the lake? Renewed and lost relations to a haunted landscape

Prof Lotten Gustafsson Reinius (Stockholm University Nordiska museet)

A decade after the largest forest fire in Sweden in modern times people, plants and animals have begun to return to the transformed area. In line with regrowth and renewal of landscape relations; I follow the ritual and narrative recall of a local forest spirit/historical memory/ghost.

"Han va ain stygging, som inki gjorde gagn men berre vilde det, som ilt va": Taking on the supernatural naturecultures of wicked beings in Norwegian folklore

Dr Guro Flinterud (University of Bergen)

The paper explores ways wicked supernatural beings destabilize existing categories of nature and culture. Using empirical examples from Norwegian folklore, I discuss how supernatural beings challenge simple categories of nature and culture and how they may be read differently

Nature and/or Cultural Nurture? What Happened to the Nisse in Iceland?

Mr Terry Gunnell (University of Iceland)

This lecture will consider the influences that brought about differences between the folk beliefs and legends of the North Atlantic Islands, many of which clearly have a background in the legends and beliefs of Norway. Was this a matter of natural difference or cultural nurture?

P14 · O-201

Non human, human, and inhumane nature and natures in fairy tales and wonder media

O-201: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15

Convenors: Dr Cristina Bacchilega (University of Hawaii-Manoa); Dr Pauline Greenhill (University of Winnipeg)

[FNLM]

We explore how human and non-human entanglements are expressed, sensed, performed and reimagined in storytelling events. Some papers suggest relational patterns across fairy tales and wonder genres/media, while others offer interpretations of specific wonder narratives in print and film.

Thinking with Fairy Tales and Other Wonder Genres: The Natures of Wonder

Dr Cristina Bacchilega (University of Hawaii-Manoa)

A reflection on the multiple natures of wonder based on folklore and fairy-tale discussions of how human/non-human entanglements in fairy tales overlap and differ from those in other wonder genres across cultures and media.

Entangled Futures in Nettle & Bone

Dr Pablo a Marca (Brown University)

This paper reads T. Kingfisher's *Nettle & Bone* (2022) as a reworking of fairy-tale wonder that entangles humans and nonhumans. It critiques social norms while imagining alternative forms of survival and interspecies kinship beyond anthropocentric paradigms.

Remaking “the World as it is”: Urban fantasy and layered spaces for wonder in the contemporary

Dr Michelle Anjirbag ()

An exploration of the tensions between consensus reality and the varied mythic sources that inform the fantastic and mythopoeic constructions in the works of Charles de Lint, including the "Jack of Kinrowan" books, "Moonheart", "Spiritwalk", and "Spirits in the Wires".

Pilina Pasifika (Indigenous Pacific Relationships between Humans and Nature)—Decolonizing Digital Discourse in Pasifika Wonder Tales

Dr kuʻualoha hoʻomanawanui (University of Hawaiʻi at Manoa)

This presentation explores Indigenous Pacific wonder tales depicting human and non-human interactions in traditional concepts of kinship relationships between them. Such retellings decolonize and disrupt mainstream concepts of hierarchical relationships often gendered through a patriarchal lens.

P15 · O-106

Haunted landscapes: landforms and water bodies from a geo-folklore perspective Panel

O-106: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Prof Dariusz Brykała (Institute of Geography and Spatial Organization PAS); Dr Robert Piotrowski (Institute of Geography and Spatial Organization Polish Academy of Sciences); Other Violetta Wróblewska (Institute of Cultural Studies, Nicolaus Copernicus University)

This panel explores how traditional folklore encodes human interaction with landforms and water bodies, often perceived as haunted or sacred. It draws on concepts from geomythology and geofolklore to examine the symbolic integration of abiotic environments into local belief systems.

In bloom: Re-storying the Problem of Algal Blooms

Miss Eliza Marley (University of Illinois Chicago (UIC))

This paper examines the role of algae in various forms of folk narrative from creation myth, to folk practice, to creatures represented by algae to trouble through the rise of harmful algal blooms due to climate change and investigate how public facing work can re-incorporate folkloric techniques.

Crater Lake's origin story and the rise of geomythology

Dr Michał Żerkowski (University of Łódź)

The paper examines the Klamath narrative about the formation of Crater Lake (giiwas), tracing its oral tradition to the Mount Mazama eruption 7,600 years ago, and situates it within a framework of geomythology and the “new euhemerism,” drawing on historical ethnographic sources and 2024 fieldwork.

Hydrology Meets Folklore: The Cultural Power of Water Bodies

Prof Dariusz Brykała (Institute of Geography and Spatial Organization PAS); Dr Robert Piotrowski (Institute of Geography and Spatial Organization Polish Academy of Sciences)

This contribution examines how distinctive hydrographic features and dynamic environmental processes—such as springs, sinkholes, lakes, torrents, and flash floods—stimulated myths, folklore, and ritual practices.

Where Did the Stone People Come From? On Folk Narratives and Their Ties to the Landscape

Other Violetta Wróblewska (Institute of Cultural Studies, Nicolaus Copernicus University)

The aim of this paper is to present Polish folk narratives from the 19th - early 20th centuries concerning stone statues resembling human figures and their connections with the natural landscape.

P16 · A-201

Nature in materiality and digital narratives Panel

A-201: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15

Convenors: Dr Goran Djurdjevich (); Prof Lidija Stojanovic (Ss. Cyril and Methodius University)

Chair: Dr Goran Djurdjevich (); Prof Lidija Stojanovic (Ss. Cyril and Methodius University)

This panel explores how nature is mediated, materialized, and reimagined in digital and physical forms. We invite discussions on storytelling at the intersection of nature, material culture, and digital media, emphasizing non-human entanglements and narrative transformation.

The Fluidity of Water in the Static Form of a Ceramic Sculpture. Environmental Art by Polish Sculptor Weronika Lucinska

Prof Grazyna Gajewska ()

The presentation focuses on sculptural works by Weronika Lucińska, whose themes revolve around water, fluidity, and the environment. The paradox of these works is that, in their static form, they beautifully convey the energy of fluidity, change, and life.

Materiality, digital narratives and ritual representations of the "tree of life" in Greek folk art (18th-early 20th century).

Dr Nadia Macha-Bizoumi (Department of History and Ethnology); Prof Manolis Varvounis (Democritus University of Thrace)

We investigate the embodiment of ecological memory in objects of folk art, through digitized museum samples of embroidery and woven fabrics, decorated with the "tree of life", focusing on the significance of this motif as coded language that narrates the connection between humans and nature.

Hyperarchaeology: nature, archaeology and digital worlds

Dr Goran Djurdjevich ()

Hyperarchaeology or archaeology without material culture is newly-coined terms focused on new spaces, new heritage and new numismatics. The paper focuses on nature within AI-generated art, AR such as Pokemon Go and digital albums Animal Kingdom/Životinjsko carstvo.

From Foundation Sacrifice to Digital Entanglements: The Legend of Rada's Bridge in Kratovo

Mrs Sylwia Siedlecka (University of Warsaw)

The legend of Rada's immurement in Kratovo, North Macedonia, evolves from a foundation sacrifice to digital and tourist narratives. It links humans, non-humans, and architecture, showing how folklore shapes memory, embodiment, and landscape.

Ecohabitus: Fostering Ecological Awareness through Traditional and Contemporary Storytelling

Prof Lidija Stojanovic (Ss. Cyril and Methodius University)

In an era deeply influenced by eco- and technological crises, this paper explores how narratives foster an ecohabitus. Grounded in ontological pluralism, it analyzes the prevalence of nature-deficit disorder in video games while examining the innovative reimagining of totems in art practices.

P17 · A-304

Narrating "the normal" and "the natural" in a catastrophic world Panel

A-304: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15

Convenors: Dr Renata Jambresic Kirin (Institute of Ethnology and Folklore Research); Dr Mojca Ramšak (University of Ljubljana)

This panel examines the narrative practices that emerge during and after catastrophic events, from natural disasters to epidemics; how they are disseminated through various media and embedded in the collective consciousness; how communities redefine the "natural" and "normal" in times of crisis.

Too natural to be normal? Making sense of the abundance of bark beetles and ticks after the Vaia storm in the Italian Alps.

Dr Deborah Nadal (Ca' Foscari University of Venice)

This paper explores what normality means when a catastrophic event triggers the outbreak of an unprecedented epidemic and exacerbates a long-standing endemic phenomenon. Grounded in ethnography, it describes where local people draw the line of normality and talk about the "new natural".

Culture, Policy, and Personal Narrative in the Wyoming County, West Virginia Water Crisis

Dr Jordan Lovejoy (College of the Holy Cross)

This paper explores how locals in Wyoming County, WV use narrative practices, sensory experiences, health anecdotes, and digital media platforms to document water pollution, address injustice in zones of extraction and sacrifice, and redefine extraction-related water pollution as a form of violence.

Without memory, there is no story to tell! The discomfort of natural and human history of the Balkan border region in Kapka Kassabova's ethnographic travelogues

Dr Renata Jambresic Kirin (Institute of Ethnology and Folklore Research)

Interpreting K. Kassabova's Balkan tetralogy, I focus on the concept of 'deep implicacy', the claim that humans are intertwined with the landscape, plants and animals, as well as on the narrative's ability to transform the earthly into a personal experience and the local into a cosmic one.

P18 · V-007

Natural forces in Slavic folk narratives Panel

V-007: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15

Convenors: Prof Dejan Ajdacic (University of Gdansk); Prof Nemanja Radulovic (University of Belgrade)

The official panel of the Folklore Committee of the International Committee of Slavists (MKS) has the aim of presenting the research of natural forces in Slavic folkloristics.

"Mother Earth" in East Slavic Popular Culture: Local Ontologies, Christian Metaphors, and Scholarly Imagination

Prof Alexander Panchenko ()

Students of folklore sometimes argued that the pre-Christian Slavonic religion included the cult of Mother Earth as a separate deity. This hypothesis does not seem to be correct. The presentation aims at assessing the data on Earth's image in Russian popular culture of the last centuries.

Frost, Sun, and Wind: Elements as Agents of Moral Judgment in Ukrainian Folk Tales

Dr Oksana Mykytenko (Institute for Art Studies, Folklore and Ethnology)

The paper examines Ukrainian folk tales where Frost, Sun, and Wind act as moral agents. Focusing on the tale "The Sun, the Frost, and the Wind," it shows how elemental forces reflect cultural hierarchies of power, survival strategies, and ethical meanings in Slavic oral tradition.

Meteorological Myth and Earthquake Myth, or How It Was Before Seismology

Dr Suzana Marjanić (Institute of Ethnology and Folklore Research)

Before seismology, people believed earthquakes were caused by a dragon moving underground, while its flight brought storms and hail. This legend reappeared after the 2020 earthquakes in Zagreb and Banija, Croatia.

Water as a Border in Serbian Folk Narratives

Prof Nemanja Radulovic (University of Belgrade)

The role water plays as a border between the worlds in folklore is well known in Slavic folkloristics. We will present some aspects of this role in Serbian oral narratives, paying special attention to different genre rules, fairy tales and belief legends at first place (specially ATU 934).

The (Un) Seen Denizens of the Air: Unbaptised Children in Polish Folk Belief

Prof Iwona Rzepnikowska (Nicolaus Copernicus University in Toruń)

The paper explores nature-related clothing in Slavic variants of ATU 510B, where heroine wear fur garments as well as cosmic or metallic dresses. The motif is read through ritual parallels, questioning human-nature boundaries and the appropriation or reverence of nature.

P19 · A-303

Monstrous landscapes Panel

A-303: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Mattias Frihammar (Stockholm University); Ms Sanna Händén-Svensson (Human Ecology Division, Lund University); Prof Lars Kaijser (Stockholm University); Dr Maja Lagerqvist (Department of Human Geography, Uppsala University)

This panel explores narratives about boundary-crossing animals and plants, like monsters or invasive species, and how they shape and are shaped by landscapes. We welcome stories in any form or media, and encourage creative methods that explore stories of nature, place, and the more-than-human.

The Big Grey Man in the Cairngorms (Scotland): Engagements between Mountaineers and Mountain Landscapes through Personal Experience Narratives and Reinterpretations of a Supernatural Entity

Mr Michele Tita (University of Tartu)

The paper explores the relationship between mountaineers and mountain landscapes in the Cairngorms (Scotland). In this regard, the paper covers stories and current reinterpretations of the Big Grey Man, a supernatural entity that mountaineers have claimed to hear or see on the mountain summits.

Bees, roses and hybrid narratives of unnatural nature

Dr Mattias Frihammar (Stockholm University)

This paper explores how narratives of invasive species construct cultural boundaries of nature. By analyzing contradictions in classifications, it shows how human interventions are normalized while non-human agencies are rendered alien, threatening, and monstrous.

Boundary-Crossings: Alien Species and the National Nature

Dr Nika Potinkara (University of Helsinki)

So-called alien species—organisms introduced beyond their ‘natural range’ through human activity—transcend both natural and cultural boundaries. Focusing on Finnish environmental discourse, this paper examines the significance of these boundaries and boundary-crossings.

Scary Monster and Super Creeps. On Storytelling in Campaigns Designated to Reduce Alien Invasive Species.

Prof Lars Kaijser (Stockholm University)

Scary Monster and Super Creeps. On Storytelling in Campaigns Designated to Reduce Alien Invasive Species.

A Growing Green Monster: Narratives of Japanese Knotweed

Dr Maja Lagerqvist (Department of Human Geography, Uppsala University)

This paper explores shifting media narratives of Japanese knotweed in Sweden, from admired ornamental to invasive “monster plant”. By analyzing press coverage since 1890s, it shows how cultural narratives mobilize fear, legitimize management, and reflect societal anxieties about nature and control.

P20 · A-301

Narrative ecologies: folklore, fiction, and cultural response to climate change Panel

A-301: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15

Convenors: Mr Jens Benohr (); Ms Tracey Hayes (University of York); Dr Jagriti Upadhyaya (Jai Narain Vyas University)

This panel examines how climate and environmental change influence cultural narratives in oral tradition, folklore, and literature, exploring how storytelling reflects, interprets, and responds to ecological disruption across diverse regions and disciplines.

Passion, Empathy, and Action: A Critical Introduction to The Climate Fiction Writers League

Dr Ceallaigh MacCath-Moran ()

The Climate Fiction Writers League is comprised of authors who transform climate narratives into literature of the fantastic. Utilizing novels by League authors, I trace a path from anthropogenic disruption to climate fiction with emphasis on the ways these authors call readers to climate action.

Storying the Future: Epew Ancestro Futurista

Mr Jens Benohr (); Prof Felipe Catrilelbun Huirileo (Kumelko); Mr Cristian Toro Ulloa (Universitat Politècnica de València)

This paper examines how Mapuche epew, oral narratives blending myth, ethics, and ecological knowledge, are reinterpreted today to address environmental and social challenges, fostering relational care and ecological imagination.

Grieving What We Cannot Bury: Ecological Grief and the Rewilding of Imagination

Other Merlijn Verduin (University of Groningen)

This paper examines how eco-grief unsettles dominant cultural narratives and creates space for renewed ways of thinking, feeling and relating. In doing so, it reframes ecological disorientation as a liminal state that disrupts inherited worldviews and creates space for ecological reimagining.

Traversing the Arboreal World: Trees as Sentient Beings in Select Indian Narratives-Classical and Folk

Dr Jagriti Upadhyaya (Jai Narain Vyas University)

P21 · A-309

Between concrete and clover: nature in urban storytelling Panel

A-309: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Miss Sigurlaug Dagsdottir (National Museum of Iceland/University of Iceland); Mrs Snjolaug G Johannesdottir (University of Iceland)

This panel explores how urban nature is perceived, narrated, and entangled with memory, emotion, and place in the city.

The Kid that Fell in the Thaw Hole and Other Place-Making Anecdotes: Sensing and Storying Urban Nature in Central Reykjavík

Prof Ólafur Rastrick (University of Iceland)

This paper examines how anecdotal memories contribute to place-making and attachment in Reykjavík’s city centre. Focusing on sensory and mnemonic engagements with the urban nature of Lake Tjörnin, it considers how the lake

shapes and sustains people's emotional bonds with the city.

Traces of Nature, Layers of Memory: Belonging in the Avion Apartment House, Bratislava

Dr Lubica Volanska (Slovak Academy of Sciences)

The narratives of the residents of a particular functionalist apartment house in Bratislava reveal how urban nature—trees, scents, light, and courtyards—coexists with concrete, nurturing sensory attachments, a sense of belonging, and the collective identity of its inhabitants across generations.

Cracks in the Concrete: Weeds, Memory and Everyday Urban Folklore

Mrs Holly Winter-Hughes (University of Birmingham)

This paper examines how overlooked forms of urban nature—such as weeds, moss and wildflowers in cracks—become anchors of memory and narrative. By tracing stories around these micro landscapes, we can explore how the ordinary green disrupts and reshapes urban belonging.

Entanglements of Nature, Memory, and Emotion: Experiencing Hólavallagarður in Reykjavík

Miss Sigurlaug Dagsdottir (National Museum of Iceland/University of Iceland); Mrs Snjolaug G Johannesdottir (University of Iceland)

In Reykjavík's historic cemetery Hólavallagarður, trees, animals, and seasonal change intertwine with memory and emotion. This paper shows how urban nature becomes a site of solace, reflection, and intergenerational remembrance.

P22 · A-201

Entangled heritage, nature and identity: transdisciplinary perspectives to storytelling Panel

A-201: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Inkeri Aula (Aalto University); Dr Sofia De La Fuente Garcia (University of Edinburgh)

This panel explores the entanglements of nature, heritage, and identity in different storytelling contexts. We invite transdisciplinary approaches to heritage as sites for personal and collective identity formation through lived experience and ecological intimacy, but also digital engagement.

Immersive encounters at Calanais: Heritage, nature and identity in practice

Dr Inkeri Aula (Aalto University); Dr Sofia De La Fuente Garcia (University of Edinburgh); Prof Saturnino Luz (University of Edinburgh); Prof Masood Masoodian (Aalto University); Dr Alicia Núñez-García (University of Edinburgh)

Walking interviews and a storytelling workshop at the Calanais megalithic sites show how engagement with heritage and landscape fosters meaning, belonging, creativity, and life purpose, then further amplified through digital and hands-on tools for ecological and cultural intimacy.

Beach Cleans, Nature Walks and Cèilidhs: Exploring the role of storytelling to navigate tensions between commodification and care in the Outer Hebrides Islands

Miss Genevieve Soucek (Southern Methodist University)

This paper will explore how locals on the Isles of Lewis and Harris experience and respond to environmental changes and island industrialization projects through engaging in conservation projects, nature education, and community building.

"Water Agoras": Narrative and Heritage in Thermal Water Collaborations

Dr Sarah Craycraft (Harvard University); Ms Yanina Taneva (Ideas Factory)

This paper reports on a collaboration between partners in Iceland, Bulgaria, and the United States around thermal waters as cultural heritage and public good. We consider the role of narrative in shaping this partnership and highlighting everyday intimacies to create change on the ground.

Conservation Narratives: Telling Stories against extractive politics.

Prof Brigitte Bönisch-Brednich (Victoria University of Wellington); Prof Ira Spieker (Institute of Saxon History and Cultural Anthropology)

This paper analyses storytelling of anti-mining activists against resource extraction projects in natural heritage sites. Such narratives are a response strategy to new mining sites in the OECD.

Stories beyond culture and nature: Building a digital archive of pounamu's living relations

Ms Alina Berg (LMU Munich and Museum of Archaeology and Anthropology Cambridge)

This project explores and digitally activates the entanglements of 'nature' and 'culture' in the context of historical Europe-Oceania relations and Māori cosmo-ontology through the lens of Indigenous and geological storytelling practices relating to pounamu (greenstone from Aotearoa New Zealand).

P23 · V-007

Healing landscapes and reshaped geography in wartime narratives Panel

V-007: Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Daria Antsybor (State Scientific Center for Cultural Heritage Protection from Man-made Disasters); Ms Nataliya Bezborodova (University of Alberta); Dr Iryna Koval-Fuchylo (Rylsky Institute of Art Studies, Folklore and Ethnology National Academy of Sciences Ukraine)

Ukraine's sacred geography has been reactivated since the full-scale Russian invasion against Ukraine. We invite reflections on the continuity and changes in Ukrainian nature narratives as the re-conception of self in the circumstances of turmoil

Donbas as a Site of Memory: Imagined Geography, Steppe, and Spoil Tips

Dr Anton Liagusha (Kyiv School of Economics)

Donbas as a Site of Memory: The steppe and spoil tips (terykony) form an imagined geography where folklore, industrial past, and war intertwine. Once symbols of labor heroism, today they mark trauma and loss, reshaping collective identity and memory in Ukraine and beyond.

Flooding as an Opportunity for Salvation: The Kakhovka Tragedy in Contemporary Narratives of War

Dr Iryna Koval-Fuchylo (Rylsky Institute of Art Studies, Folklore and Ethnology National Academy of Sciences Ukraine)

On June 6 2023 Russian occupation forces blew up Kakhovka hydroelectric power station. More than 80 settlements were flooded. The exact number of victims is currently unknown. This man-made natural disaster gave rise to narratives about flooding as an opportunity to escape from occupation.

Nature, space, and the intangible heritage of the Crimean Tatars

Ms Aleksandra Krzyżaniak (Centre for Migration Studies AMU)

Tomatoes, orchids, and wheat: Hosting Ukrainian refugees in Poland through the lens of nature.

Drawing from research on hosting Ukrainian refugees in Poland, this paper explores how rural landscapes and nature-oriented practices such as gardening became means for continuity, autonomy, and healing. Earth and plants became symbols of resilience, gratitude, and hope in times of war.

P23B · O-101

(Workshop)Nature(s) in Narrative: Memory, Home, and Environment in Storytelling Panel

O-101: Sun 14 Jun 16:00-17:45

Convenors: Ms Anastazie Toros (Loughborough University)

Chair: Dr Daria Antsybor (State Scientific Center for Cultural Heritage Protection from Man-made Disasters); Ms Nataliya Bezborodova (University of Alberta); Dr Iryna Koval-Fuchylo (Rylsky Institute of Art Studies, Folklore and Ethnology National Academy of Sciences Ukraine)

Nature(s) in Narrative is a participatory workshop by Anastazie Toros exploring memory, home, and environment through storytelling and embodied practice. Using imaginative exercises, participants connect personal stories with ecological themes of belonging, resilience, and responsibility.

This panel has no accepted papers

P24 · O-106

From oceans to outer space: cultural cosmologies across contemporary narratives Panel

O-106: Sun 14 Jun 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Francesca Arnavas (University of Tartu); Dr Christina Lord (University of North Carolina Wilmington); Dr Sang-Keun Yoo (Marist University)

This panel explores how speculative fiction reimagines myth and cultural cosmologies to challenge dominant epistemologies. Through mermaids, aliens, and cyborgs, the papers examine posthuman pasts and futures shaped by environmental collapse, Indigenous knowledge, and feminist critique.

Epistemologies in Orbit: Indigenous Cosmologies and the Limits of Rationalism in the French Television Series "UFO(s)"

Dr Christina Lord (University of North Carolina Wilmington)

This paper analyzes the French television show "OVNI(s)" ["UFO(s)"] as a satirical critique of Western scientific rationalism. Through genre hybridity and engagement with the "conte philosophique", the series foregrounds Indigenous cosmologies and challenges Western conceptualizations of nature.

Dark and Watery Metamorphoses: Mermaids, Dystopian Fiction, Posthumanism

Dr Francesca Arnava (University of Tartu)

This paper explores Italian novel *Sirene* by Laura Pugno, where the mermaid becomes a hybrid figure of dystopia, climate catastrophe, and posthuman possibility. Drawing on myth, manga, and dark fairy tale, the novel critiques anthropocentrism and reimagines humanity through watery, feminist lenses.

Spiders, empire and Star Wars

Mx Carlotta Ottonello (University of Birmingham)

This paper explores representation of folk-nature relations as portrayed in the Ghorman story in the tv show *Star Wars: Andor*. The paper will explore the introduction of the Ghor people and their relationship with their planet's ecology, and how Empire then intervenes and disrupts these relations.

The 'Sloth Effect': Mashavi as a Mode of Post-Anthropocentric Storytelling in Lauren Beukes' Zoo City (2011).

Mx Louise Wigglesworth (University of Kent)

This paper analyses the blurring of the human/non-human boundary through the centrality of familiar-like mashavi in Lauren Beukes' *Zoo City* and the extent to which this leads to a mode of post-anthropocentric storytelling.

Mythic Transfuturism: Asian Myth to Imagine Transformed Future Humans in Larissa Lai's Salt Fish Girl

Dr Sang-Keun Yoo (Marist University)

This paper examines *Salt Fish Girl's* transfuturism, where Chinese myth and posthumanism merge to envision a radically transformed humanity. Lai rewrites the Nu Wa myth, critiques colonialism and Orientalism, and reimagines the future through mythic narratives rather than technological progress.

P25 · A-306

Exploring the roles of econarratives in the (re)negotiation of identity Panel

A-306: Sun 14 Jun 16:00-17:45, Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45

Convenors: Dr Jessica Hampton (University of Liverpool)

Chair: Dr Jessica Hampton (University of Liverpool)

Through multi-lingual, multi-modal, and multi-species storytelling, this panel explores how econarratives can contribute to the (re)construction of global identities that centre our interconnected human and more-than-human identity as citizens of Earth.

'The end of civilisation': Exploring children's eco-narratives through multimodal discourse analysis

Dr Clare Cunningham (York St John University); Prof Helen Sauntson (York St John University)

This paper explores how children (aged 5–11) use multimodal econarratives to express their views on climate change. Findings show strong awareness of ecological harm, emotional responses such as eco-anxiety, and a tendency to depict humans as heroes or bystanders, rather than as causes of damage.

Gut feelings and transatlantic bread narratives

Dr Prisca Augustyn (Florida Atlantic University)

This paper explores the narrative that "bread is more digestible in Europe than in the US" as an econarrative that reveals how food chauvinism reflects narratives about culture (baking and fermentation) the body (gut health and the microbiome) and the environment (wheat and glyphosate).

Bees, Stories, and Becoming: Indigenous Econarratives of Nature and Identity

Ms Julianna Faria (Amazon Research International)

Indigenous Asháninka narratives of stingless bees reveal a deep respect for nature, linking oral tradition, medicinal honey, and hopes for the future with ecological stewardship. This research exemplifies storytelling as a pillar of human-more-than-human connection, identity, and resilience.

Eco-Mnemonics: Plants, Animals, and Land as Memory-Devices in Moose to Moccasins

Ms Shamna Razia (PG and Research Department of English, PSMO College,)

This paper interprets Madeline Katt Theriault's *Moose to Moccasins* through eco-mnemonics, showing how land, species, and material culture anchor memory, positioning Indigenous autobiography as an ecological archive central

to environmental humanities and climate ethics.

Characterising the British as "Animal Lovers": a comparison of North East Scottish and Polish perspectives on relationships between British humans and their pets

Mr David Fayle ()

This paper addresses the notion that British people are particularly close to the nonhuman animals they live with. Using individual perspectives from Aberdeenshire and its Polish immigrant population, I reflect on my own English culture to evaluate the validity of the "animal lover" narrative.

P26 · O-206

Revisiting oicotypes: cultural ecologies and disciplinary boundaries Panel

O-206: Sun 14 Jun 11:15-13:00, 16:00-17:45

Convenors: Dr Mircea Padurar (Alexandru Ioan Cuza University of Iași); Dr Nicola Perencin (Università degli Studi di Padova)

When introduced into folkloristics, the concept of oicotype produced a shift of paradigm. In our scientific landscape, increasingly globalised and digitised, could the same concept be used to reframe the discussion on cultural ecologies and challenge the artificial nature of disciplinary boundaries?

The Concept of Oicotype(s). Few Remarks Starting from Romanian Folklore about strigoi & co.

Ms Otilia Hedeșan (West University of Timisoara)

This paper examines Romanian folk beliefs about strigoi, focusing on two modes of storytelling: (1) autonomous narratives and (2) fragmentary, contextual versions. The case study reflects on the revenant's motif, oicotype, and how milieu shapes narrative forms.

Ecotypes and translation: a productive framework for foundational narratives in the history of translation theory

Dr Iulia Cosma (Università di Padova)

Could Von Sydow's notion of ecotype illuminate how the "foundational myths" of translation circulate in the history of translation theorization? Viewed as ecotypization, their use in scholarship reveals how translation theory evolves through adaptation, localization, and refunctionalization.

Mapping Mythical Landscapes: An Ecotype Approach to International Folktales with Greco-Latin Parallels

Dr Nicola Perencin (Università degli Studi di Padova)

Previous scholarship has identified hundreds of parallels between international folktales and Greco-Latin literature. But how many of these folktales actually circulated in areas once inhabited by Greco-Latin civilisation? How could an ecotype approach improve the comparison between the two?

P27 · O-106

Narrating nature, performing identity: Ukrainian folklore in domestic, digital, and diasporic worlds Panel

O-106: Tue 16 Jun 16:15-18:00

Convenors: Dr Oleksandr Pankiev (University of Alberta); Dr Dmytro Yesypenko (Kule Folklore Centre, University of Alberta)

This panel explores how Ukrainian folklore and cultural narratives engage with nature—material and symbolic, domestic and diasporic, analog and digital—as a medium of memory, identity, and resilience. It considers nature as a dynamic site of narrative construction and cultural meaning-making.

Ballads of Immurement: The Cosmology of Foundation Sacrifice in Eastern Europe

Dr Victoria Somoff (Dartmouth College)

The "Walled-Up Wife" ballad, found across Eastern Europe, tells of a structure that will not stand until a woman is immured in its foundations. This paper highlights Ukrainian variants, showing how the ballad form reveals the cosmological rationale of foundation sacrifice.

Narrating Change: How Institutional Transitions Shape Ukrainian Canadian Archives

Mrs Nataliia Yesypenko (University of Alberta, Kule Folklore Centre)

In my presentation, I examine the transfer of archival collections in Edmonton, Canada, from the Ukrainian Canadian Archives and Museum of Alberta to the Bohdan Medwidsky Ukrainian Folklore Archives, and how UCAMA's rich

historical holdings reshape BMUFA's mission, narrative, and accessibility.

Sounding Ecocide: Wartime Music and Environmental Testimony in Ukraine

Dr Olga Zaitseva-Herz (University of Alberta)

This paper explores how Ukrainian musicians respond to wartime ecocide through songs that blend environmental awareness, cultural memory, and activism. Through lyrics, visuals, and fundraising efforts, they transform music into a medium of ecological and humanitarian resilience.

P28 · O-202

Archived nature Panel

O-202: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Olha Petrovych (Estonian Literary Museum); Dr Liina Saarlo (Estonian Literary Museum)

Chair: Dr Olha Petrovych (Estonian Literary Museum); Dr Liina Saarlo (Estonian Literary Museum)

This panel explores how folk narratives reflect and shape understandings of nature and traditional archives, through both traditional and digital lenses, engaging with posthumanist, ecological, and ontological approaches to cultural memory.

Folklore Archives in the Ecological Knowledge Discourse

Dr Ave Goršič (Estonian Literary Museum)

This paper explores how folklore archives in the Baltics and Scandinavia engage with ecological themes, focusing on the role of archived nature folklore in shaping public discourse amid climate concerns.

Whose voices speak about the nature in the archive?

Dr Liina Saarlo (Estonian Literary Museum)

Place-lore has been used for mapping and interpreting the nature. Now it is increasingly used to market a place or to establish conservation restrictions. Archiving enhances the lore's credibility and significance initiating a process of heritagization. What is the nature of archived narratives?

Material Connections: Holy Rag Wells as Transtemporal Archives

Miss Scarlett-Electra LeBlanc (Leverhulme Trust Centre for Water Cultures, University of Hull)

This paper examines Holy Rag Wells as transtemporal archives, which are in possession of long literary histories, as well as preserving recent offerings imbued with meaning. Using field work and literary analysis, I consider how wells act as a place for the past, present, and future to communicate.

P29 · A-303

Narrating nature in times of war Panel

A-303: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15

Convenors: Dr Anna Olenenko (University of Alberta); Dr Oleksandr Pankiev (University of Alberta)

Chair: Dr Anna Olenenko (University of Alberta); Dr Oleksandr Pankiev (University of Alberta)

This panel explores how narratives of war reflect and reframe human-environment relations, revealing new ways of thinking about nature under conditions of violence and rupture, and how storytelling challenges anthropocentrism and reimagines the non-human world.

Gardens of Memory: Nature, Loss, and Displacement in the Narratives of Vilcha Residents

Dr Viktoria Naumenko (FernUniversität in Hagen)

Based on oral histories of Vilcha residents displaced after Chernobyl and again by war, the paper explores how narratives of nature function as symbolic resources shaping memory, identity, and survival strategies.

After the Disaster: Shifting Narratives about the Dnipro Wetlands

Dr Anna Olenenko (University of Alberta)

After the 2023 Kakhovka HES destruction, debates on the Dnipro wetlands mobilize historical narratives framing them as symbolic and nationally significant landscapes, which are evolving into environmental narratives advocating conservation, protection, and ecological recovery.

Stories of War and Nature: Narrating Ecocide for Children

Dr Tetiana Perga (TU Berlin)

This paper explores narrative strategies for adapting traumatic war experiences for children audiences, fostering simultaneously responsibility for nature's protection alongside patriotism, empathy, love for the motherland, and humanistic values.

Eco-Social Agency as Continuity and Resistance in Post-Soviet Latvia

Dr Ieva Garda-Rozenberga (Institute of Literature, Folklore and Art, University of Latvia)

The landscapes of Latvia, reshaped by the Second World War and Soviet rule, gave rise to environmentalism as an eco-social agency. Nature became a symbol of belonging and resistance, meaning that caring for the environment became inextricably linked with caring for home and nation.

P30 · A-306

The nature(s) of enchantment and disenchantment: Moon – Sun pendulums in narrative traditions Panel

A-306: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00

Convenors: Prof Chris Knight (University College London); Dr Helena Tuzinska (Comenius University in Bratislava, Faculty of Arts)

This panel explores the shifting roles of the Moon and Sun in folk narratives, focusing on how their dynamic relationship structures enchantment, disenchantment, and representations of other transitions. We examine lunar and solar symbolism as narrative pendulums across diverse cultural contexts.

The Sun and the Moon in the narrative tradition of the Komi people

Dr Asta Laugaliene (Vilnius University); Miss Lyubov Liski (University of Helsinki)

The presentation examines the Komi mythological beliefs about the Sun and the Moon, analyzes the semantic and symbolic meanings of these celestial bodies and their expression in folklore and ritual texts, as well as in language.

Celestial Aesthetics in WitchTok: Lunar-Solar Symbolism and the Dynamics of Enchantment Online

Ms Myrto Giareni ()

This paper examines how WitchTok creators use moon and sun symbolism to frame enchantment, transformation, and identity. It argues that celestial aesthetics form a digital narrative where lunar-solar cycles guide spiritual creativity and belonging.

Old Man Moon: Renewal and Transformation in Batek Cosmologies

Dr Ivan Tacey (University of Plymouth)

Among the Batek of Malaysia, the moon embodies renewal, rebirth, and transformation. This paper shows how moon myths and sun-moon oppositions form part of a deep, universal pattern of myth and ritual, evidence of an ancient culture-forming event inscribed in human consciousness since prehistory.

Silver Moon and Golden Sun: Dialogic Voices in Fairytale Symbolism

Dr Helena Tuzinska (Comenius University in Bratislava, Faculty of Arts)

Revisiting ritual syntax theory (Knight et al. 1995) and wondertale symbolism (Cardigos 1996; Vaz da Silva 2023), this paper explores how silver Moon and golden Sun attributes in Slovak fairy tales signal kinship reconfigurations aligned with cosmic rhythms.

P31 · O-101

Nature as subject and symbol: ecological perspectives in folk song traditions

O-101: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Kati Kallio (Finnish Literature Society); Dr Marjeta Pisk (ZRC SAZU)

[\[CCC\]](#)

The panel examines how folk songs across cultures portray nature as both symbol and agent, exploring shifting meanings through oral transmission and their role in ecological knowledge, ethics, and multispecies relations.

Negotiating Authenticity and Ecological Imaginaries in Slovenian Folk Song Interpretations

Dr Mojca Kovačič (ZRC SAZU)

This paper explores how Slovenian folk singers negotiate authenticity both on stage within heritage institutions and through embodied ties to nature and place, revealing ecological imaginaries that connect humans, ancestors, and the more-than-human.

The results of deforestation: social and ecological consequences in loggers' songs

Prof Alf Arvidsson (Umeå University)

From the 1890s into the 1970s, loggers' songs was a genre in Sweden where ecological awareness and cultural critique was voiced, also reaching into popular music and protest songs. An 1893 song of deforestation is taken as a starting point of a discussion of productive tropes and the logger persona.

Forest in Lament / Lament in Forest

Dr Viliina Silvonen (University of Eastern Finland / Finnish Literature Society)

This paper examines the meanings and multiple connections between laments and forests in Karelia and Finland from the early 20th century to the present, with a focus on contemporary interpretations.

P32 · A-301

Earth, wind and fire: narrating the elemental in the Anthropocene Panel

A-301: Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Oliwia Murawska (Leopold-Franzens-Universität Innsbruck); Prof Manuel Trummer (Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität, Munich (LMU))

In this panel, we will explore narrative representations of the “elemental” in the Anthropocene. We ask how human entanglements with environments experienced as elemental are narrated or to what extent elemental substances are conceived as narrative agents that grant us access to the posthuman.

Megaflora and the Geological Sublime: Elemental Narratives of Primordial Trees

Prof Monique Scheer (University of Tuebingen)

The element of wood is narrativized as ancient by those who encounter very large trees, imagined as part of a gigantic and inhuman landscape, integrating them into a geological sublime shared by Romantic poets as well as scientists and whetting extractivist and commercial appetites.

Elemental Religion: Gold Rush Narratives and the Alchemy of Empire

Prof Pamela Klassen (University of Toronto)

This paper analyses how gold rush heritage sites in Aotearoa New Zealand, Australia, Canada, and the United States narrate settler discoveries of gold as a kind of “elemental religion,” enabling and participating in the alchemy of empire: shape-shifting Indigenous land into settler colonies.

Posthuman Narration: Elemental Storytelling in Ecology and Art

Dr Oliwia Murawska (Leopold-Franzens-Universität Innsbruck)

In the face of ecological crises, storytelling and our concepts of it are being challenged. Using elemental stories from the realms of ecology and art, I like to show how narration can be conceptualised as posthuman – that is, beyond anthropocentric and dualistic notions.

P33 · O-206

(Co)narrating nature in a written form Panel

O-206: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Ms Katre Kikas (Estonian Literary Museum); Dr Hanne Pico Larsen (Tuck School of Business)

The panel focuses on the co-authored, collaborative, multi-voiced written narratives and asks about the role and meaning of nature (or its representations) in those co-narrating events.

Nature and the natural in discursive struggles over the Anthropocene

Ms Caroline Reinhammar (University of Gothenburg)

Discussions on climate change online reveal how trust, science, and nature events are negotiated through memes, myths, and everyday observations. By analyzing dialogues in a Facebook group, this study explores how contemporary folklore sustains or resists belief in the climate crisis

Small witnessing stories: A dialogic narrative view of readers and writers of Google Maps reviews of memorial museums

Prof Chaim Noy ()

The talk examines how online reviews of memorial museums may function as mediated witnessing stories. It approaches visitor reviews as small socio-material stories that re-narrate museums’ canonic narrative, and illuminate the online-offline relations in terms of audiences’ narratives practices.

Nature-related experience stories as part of a hobby group's shared tradition

Dr Mare Kalda (Estonian Literary Museum)

The autoethnography-based presentation on geocaching focuses on written online-narratives of various lengths (or “logs” as referred to in the game terminology) that can be found on a shared website of geocachers. These also include entries inspired by nature

(Co)authored Narratives of Nature: The Slovenian Diaspora in Australia and Multi-voiced Stories of Home, Identity, and Belonging

Mr Luka Kropivnik (ZRC SAZU, Institute of Slovenian Ethnology)

This paper examines multi-voiced narratives of the Slovenian diaspora in Australia, including SALUK writers, showing how nature—as home or foreign—shapes hybrid identities, belonging, and co-created stories bridging memories of Slovenia and experiences in Australia.

P34 · O-101

New animism and other than human life forms in belief narratives: agency, personhood, interactions

O-101: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15

Convenors: Dr Mare Kõiva (Estonian Literary Museum); Dr Maria Palleiro (Buenos Aires Universitu)

[\[BNN\]](#)

Belief narratives frequently portray other-than-human life forms (such as animals, plants, mushrooms, or inanimate objects) as having agency and even personhood. The panel invites papers exploring this multifaceted topic from multidisciplinary perspectives.

Dogs, birds and other mythical beings in South American political discourses: new animism in belief narratives

Dr Maria Palleiro (Buenos Aires Universitu)

This paper analyses how South American leaders like Nicolás Maduro and Javier Milei use belief narratives dealing with animal mythical beings in political discourses. Despite opposing ideologies, both draw on animistic and zoomorphic imaginaries to foster voter identification in their campaigns.

"Mushrooms have their own paths, just like people." A study of interspecies relationships in the forests of southern Lithuania

Ms Dalia Blazulionyte (Institute of Lithuanian Literature and Folklore)

This paper explores narratives of mushroom pickers in southern Lithuania, where mushrooms are treated as beings with agency and personhood. Through stories, rituals, and taboos, foragers articulate interspecies relations that shape human life near the forest.

Speaking the Language of Snakes: The Animalistic Figure of the Charmer in Lithuanian Belief Narratives

Dr Daiva Vaitkevičienė (Institute of Lithuanian Literature and Folklore)

This paper explores the figure of the charmer in Lithuanian belief narratives, emphasizing the connection between charmers and snakes. By embodying animalistic traits the charmer acts as an intermediary between humans and the more-than-human world.

P35 · O-101

Enchanted landscapes guiding human-nature interactions

O-101: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00, 16:15-18:00

Convenors: Dr Kaarina Koski (University of Turku)

Chair: Dr Kirsten Møllegaard (University of Hawai'i at Hilo, USA); Prof Nemanja Radulovic (University of Belgrade)

[\[BNN\]](#)

Belief narratives related to natural sites not only reflect the close bonds between humans and their environment but reveal the creative processes of how these places are loaded with meanings by folklore. Papers exploring site-specific beliefs of human-nature interactions are welcome in this panel.

Narratives and interactions of the practitioners of Afro-Brazilian religions with haunted places and wandering souls in Japan

Dr Daniela Calvo ()

This paper offers an insight into the forms how imaginaries and narratives about haunted places and wandering souls in Japan interact with Brazilian breadth and historical depth of the code and discourse about spirits and possession.

Vibrant tales that connect us all through folklore tourism: A case study into the folklore-centric gaze using animism.

Ms Vivian Sakko ()

Since the relationship between tourism, the landscape and folklore is rather complicated and includes certain (frequently conflicting) tensions, this paper explores a sustainable strategy for folklore tourism practices that is considerate of landscape, people living in a place, and heritage value.

Connecting the Human World to the Landscape of sites of the Fairy Otherworld: Spiritual Tales with Fairies from a Fairy Shaman on the Isle of Skye, Scotland and Fairy Artist in Dartmoor, England

Miss Melissa LaRose (University of Aberdeen)

Explore the narratives of connections to landscapes of fairy sites with tales from a Fairy Shaman on the Isle of Skye who communes with fairies to embrace his spirituality and an author/artist in Dartmoor, England who connects through her garden to create her sculptures and novels.

P36 · A-304

Regenerative narratives: (eco)feminist entanglements with nature Panel

A-304: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Niina Hämäläinen (Kalevala Society); Dr Natasa Polgar (Institute of Ethnology and Folklore Research); Prof Jennifer Schacker (University of Guelph)

This panel focuses on knowledge of nature in a variety of narratives, critiquing distorted notions of woman, sisterhood, or the feminine. We take an ecofeminist approach on entanglements of gendered domination and exploitation of nature to re-examine cultural categories and explore alternatives.

Ecosystem of folk lyric poetry

Dr Niina Hämäläinen (Kalevala Society)

This paper will discuss the ecosystem of folklore invented by research history. By concentrating on folklore scholars in Finland it will shed light on ideological concepts and emphasis of oral lyric songs in terms of articulation of nature and female.

‘My Mother Could See the Future’: Sámi Feminists and Artists on Epistemic and Ecological Renewal through Rematriation

Dr JoAnn Conrad (Diablo Valley College. Univ. of Iceland)

Sámi feminists and women artists are working to dismantle colonial structures of power by reimagining a world grounded in Indigenous Sámi practices that include the role of gender, co-productive humans/non-human relations in the remains of patriarchy, capitalism, and colonialism.

Saffron, Beeswax, and a Sense of Design: Ecofeminist Aesthetics, Vibrant Matter, and Jessie M. King’s How Cinderella Was Able To Go To the Ball (1924)

Prof Jennifer Schacker (University of Guelph)

In King’s Cinderella (1924), the heroine learns wax-relief textile design (batik) to make her own gown, using materials from home and garden. Drawing on Jane Bennett’s notion of “vibrant matter,” I explore this depiction of non-human animals and plantlife as active collaborators in the tale’s magic.

From Witchcraft to Madness: Narratives of Women, Nature, and Control

Dr Natasa Polgar (Institute of Ethnology and Folklore Research)

This paper explores how witchcraft trials and histories of madness reframed women’s ecological knowledge as uncanny or abject. An ecofeminist lens reveals how such narratives suppressed female agency and gendered “nature” as threat.

P37 · O-106

Nature(s) in the ritual narratives and practices of Southwest China Panel

O-106: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00

Convenors: Dr Valentina Punzi (EPHE); Miss Zuoxi Yueqi ()

Discussant: Dr Mark Bender (The Ohio State University)

The panel explores nature(s) in ritual narratives and practices, based on the study of local ritual manuscripts and/or oral expressions and ethnographic documentation concerning plants and animals as well as their place in the cosmologies of different ethnic communities in Southwest China.

The Camel of Nine Poisonous Trees: A Bon Exorcistic Ritual Among the Na (Mosuo) People

Mr Naljor Tsering Tewo ()

This paper uncovers a nearly-lost Bon camel exorcistic ritual from the Na(Mosuo) region. By analyzing the "toxic-plant camel" effigy's symbolic mechanisms, it reveals shared exorcistic frameworks across ethnic groups in the Bon cultural sphere, contributing rare documentation to ritual scholarship.

**“Delight in the sound, spread the conch-shell mat, and pour the turquoise medicine”:
sensory engagement with nature in bya rdang ritual narratives**

Dr Valentina Punzi (EPHE)

Based on the analysis of flora and fauna motifs featured in a recently discovered 12-text ritual corpus - bya rdang (literally: bird perch) - from the northeastern Tibetan Plateau, the presentation will contribute to documenting and cross-comparing ritual narratives in Southwest China.

Eggs Beyond Community Boundaries: The Role of Eggs in Soul-Calling Rituals in Eastern Minyag

Dr Wei Chen (The University of Tartu)

In Eastern Minyag, eggs in soul-calling rituals show how natural elements adapt to diverse cultural needs and shape belonging.

A Hunter's Dilemma in the Age of Ecological Protection

Miss Zuoxi Yueqi ()

P38 · A-311

Intersections of nature and the supernatural in story worlds of Eastern Asia Panel

A-311: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Mark Bender (The Ohio State University); Dr Alevtina Solovyeva (The University of Tartu)

This panel explores “story worlds” from cultures in contemporary Eastern Asia created in formats of epic, belief narrative, ritual, digital media, poetry, graphic art, etc. with an emphasis on imagery of nature and the supernatural and their relevance to social and environmental issues of the day.

Narratives of some mountain deities and local spirits in Amdo

Dr Judit Béres (Dharma Gate Buddhist College)

The paper examines Amdo Tibetan narratives of mountain gods and local spirits, analyzing their ritual, symbolic and socio-cultural functions within the oral tradition of the region.

Interweaving Nature and the Supernatural: Ecocritical Readings of the Story of Myanglung

Mr Yadab Prasad Adhikari (Tribhuvan University, Ratna Rajyalaxmi Campus); Mr Rabindra Baral (Janta Multiple Campus); Prof Motikala Subba Dewan ()

This presentation examines the story of Myanglung, the stone cat, a Limbu myth, through ecocritical frameworks, showing how it interweaves nature, environment, and the supernatural. Passed down orally, it highlights human-nonhuman relations and ecological-cultural interdependence.

Lords of the earth and water in Mongolian eco-cosmology and socio-political environment

Dr Alevtina Solovyeva (The University of Tartu)

The lords of the earth and water, take one of the central places in Mongolian mythology and vernacular beliefs. The presentation looks at the earlier and contemporary forms of these beliefs, their authority and manifestations.

**Disappearing storyworlds, precarious environments, and the work of cultural sustainability:
Perspectives on Tibetan oral traditions in contemporary China**

Dr Timothy Thurston (University of Leeds)

This paper will examine how attention to storyworlds can help tradition bearers and interested culture brokers to better support the sustainability of endangered cultures through an attention to the links between narratives, storyworlds, and natural environments..

The Imagined Environment and Landscapes in the Northeast Chinese Shamans' Narratives of Historicization and Mythologization.

Mr Haozhen Li (University of Tartu)

This paper focuses on the world of storytelling of the shamanic practitioners among the Han Chinese in northeast China, exploring the agencies of the multidimensional nature and animal spirits in the belief narratives of historicization and mythologization.

P39 · A-304

Ritual narratives: animals and plants in ritual contexts Panel

A-304: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00, 16:15-18:00

Convenors: Dr Jenny Butler (University College Cork); Dr Mare Kõiva (Estonian Literary Museum); Dr Tatiana Minniyakhmetova (University of Innsbruck); Other Irina Stahl (Institute of Sociology (Romanian Academy))

We invite paper proposals related to nature, animals, and plants in various rituals; examples include but are not limited to balancing rituals, healing rituals, life-cycle rituals, the ritual year, and crisis-solving rituals.

The Sheep in Baltic Finnic Traditions

Dr Mare Kõiva (Estonian Literary Museum)

This study investigates sheep-related traditions among the BalticFinnic peoples, with particular attention to ritual calendar observances, everyday ritual practices and incantations, their role within masking customs, and their significance in social practices.

From Transhumance to Festivity: St. George's Day in Bulgaria

Dr Lina Gergova (Institute of Ethnology and Folklore Studies with Ethnographic Museum at the Bulgarian Academy of Sciences)

The paper explores St. George's Day in Bulgaria as a remnant of migratory sheep herding traditions. Using archives, interviews, and maps, it argues that the holiday's prominence reflects the lasting imprint of seasonal pastoral rhythms on local economies, culture, and festive life.

Dew Between Nature and Magic

Other Luca Rádler (Moholy Nagy University of Art and Design)

At dawn on Saint George's Day in the Carpathian Basin, women's rites for animal protection sacralized agrarian space. Through phenomenology and East-Central European ethnography, this study links embodied ritual ecologies to contemporary reflections on human-nature relations.

The Cow between the Earthly and the Sacred: Ritual Practices and Narratives in the Ukrainian Carpathians

Mrs Kira Sadoja ()

This paper explores the cow's role in Carpathian folk culture as a mediator between the earthly and the sacred, focusing on rituals, beliefs, and narratives from 1987–2019 fieldwork that highlight cattle's economic, social, and symbolic significance.

P40 · A-301

Reimagining plant-human entanglements through multimodal approaches Panel

A-301: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Miss Alexandra Czeglédi (University of Pécs (Hungary)); Dr Judit Farkas (University of Pécs)

Chair: Miss Alexandra Czeglédi (University of Pécs (Hungary)); Dr Judit Farkas (University of Pécs)

Human-plant relations are foundational yet often reduced to utilitarian views. This panel explores plant agency and subjectivity through interdisciplinary narratives, drawing on ethnobotany, multispecies studies, and ecological knowledge to rethink interspecies cohabitation.

'Critical peat/bog studies' in bog body research and archaeology - anthropo(de)centrism, multivocality and multispecies perspectives, for more-than-human pasts, presents and futures

Mrs Jennifer Carey Mikkelsen (Lund University)

The talk explores ongoing PhD research centred around the 'bog body phenomenon' which takes place at the intersections of archaeology, environmental humanities, critical plant studies, vegetal ontology and more-than-human/posthumanism.

Living Gardens and Teaching Plants: Buddhist Approaches to Plant Agency and Interspecies Communication

Mrs Julie Charlotte Ruby Clausen (University of Oslo)

This ethnographic fieldwork examines how Buddhist principles of interconnectedness translate into practical recognition of plant subjectivity. Research explores how monastic communities develop responsive relationships through attentive cultivation practices.

Learning from Bracken: On Multispecies Relationality

Dr Barbara Turk Niskač (ZRC SAZU)

Drawing on walking ethnography and Tsing's notion of the 'arts of noticing,' this paper examines bracken's role in multispecies relationality within plots of land related to animal husbandry. Integrating photography, animation, and eco-printing, it explores what we can learn from bracken.

Entangled Mobility: Phytocritical Perspectives on Transport

Mrs Zsuzsanna Bodóné Hofecker (University of Szeged)

A phytocritical interpretation of Salomé Jashi's *Taming the Garden* and Joseph Tasnádi's *Joyride* highlights often overlooked plant agency in human transportation, evoking human care and kinship, and fostering more-than-human perspectives on movement and ecological entanglement.

Between Branches and Relations: Arboreal Practices and Plant Agency in the Ethnography of Urban Tree Climbers

Miss Amalia Campagna (University of Milan); Mrs Viola Di Tullio (LUISS, Rome and IUSS, Pavia); Mr Alessandro Guglielmo (University of Milan)

An ethnography of urban tree climbers reveals how pruning practices activate interspecies attunement, challenging modern views of plants as passive resources and instead recognizing vegetal subjectivity and agency.

P41 · O-202

Beyond the supernatural Panel

O-202: Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45

Convenors: Miss Emily Bianchi (Ohio State University); Dr Fionnan Mac Gabhann (University College Cork)

Chair: Miss Emily Bianchi (Ohio State University); Dr Fionnan Mac Gabhann (University College Cork)

The papers in this panel question the idea that the supernatural is necessarily beyond the natural or ordinary. Case studies from Ireland, Poland, and the U.S. explore the numinous and otherworldly aspects of reality, and how people relate to demons, spirits, fairies, and the afterlife.

Exploring Belief in Spirits of the Dead in the Memorates of Irish Death Care Workers

Prof Ray Cashman (Indiana University)

Memorates about experiences with spirits of the dead are common among death care workers in Ireland such as undertakers and embalmers. Such narratives reveal a range of belief, disbelief, and hedged positions on the existence of spirits, an afterlife, and the supernatural or numinous in general.

Common and Not Strange: Memorates of the Sabbathday Lake Shakers

Miss Emily Bianchi (Ohio State University)

The Shakers, a US monastic community, tell stories about their interactions with ancestors. I consider the types of interactions remembered and retold and instances so unremarkable that they do not bear repeating, complicating the distinctions between natural and supernatural, PEN and memorate.

Otherworldly encounters in the narrative repertoire of a female storyteller from the northwest of Ireland

Dr Ailbhe Nic Giolla Chomhaill (Ollscoil na Gaillimhe University of Galway)

This paper will address and engage with the panel's wider themes by analyzing the relationship between the numinous and natural worlds in a corpus of fairy legends and memorates recorded from Sorcha Mhic Grianna (1875-1964), a female storyteller from northwest Donegal, in the late 1930s.

The Ethos of Resistance: Contemporary Demonology in the West of Ireland

Dr Fionnan Mac Gabhann (University College Cork)

This paper analyses the unique demonology of an Irish priest, Eddie Bheairte Ó Confhaola. Composed from an admixture of sources and in response to present needs, this demonology offers both a spiritual diagnosis and a remedy for a range of contemporary social ills.

Polish folk demonology as everyday knowledge

Dr Elwira Wilczyńska ()

Polish demonology constitutes an alternative ontology in which non-human beings are woven into everyday life. The existence of demons shapes rituals, work and morality, mediating between nature, culture and the Other – undermining the category of the "supernatural".

P42 · V-008

Lives with(out) nature? Representations and narratives of (lost) rural worlds Panel

V-008: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Katja Geisenhainer (Frobenius Institute for Research in Cultural Anthropology, Frankfurt); Dr Katharina Lange (Leibniz-Zentrum Moderner Orient)

This panel explores representations of "lost" rural liveworlds through narrative and/or visual means. Asking specifically what values are accorded to "nature" in these representations, the panel invites case studies from a broad range of historical as well as contemporary contexts and settings.

"Back in the day, my grandparents lived in a perfect symbiosis with nature". Fishing, tourism, and nature in the Danube Delta

Mrs Petruta Teampau (Babeş-Bolyai University, Cluj, Romania)

I explore different narratives and discourses to analyze the multi-semantic descriptions of nature in a small fishing community and place of sustainable tourism, in the Danube Delta: identity, source of food and livelihood, a place of relaxation, a resource to be saved and protected, or just home.

Lost Worlds of Warta and Narew River. 'Past presencing' in Nature Conservation Practices

Dr Adam Pisarek (University of Silesia in Katowice)

The paper investigates how Polish wetland national parks and local activists draw on narratives of lost agrarian and amphibian worlds to ascribe distinctive values to protected landscapes, framing these efforts as practices of 'past presencing' (Macdonald 2013).

Layers of Loss: Narrating the Disappearance of Woodcutters' Settlements in the Bohemian Forest

Ms Anna Kolářová (Institute of Ethnology, Czech Academy of Sciences)

This paper explores narratives of the "lost" Bohemian Forest through the former German-speaking woodcutters' settlements of Bučina and Knížecí Pláně, tracing how memories of bark beetle, displacement, and overgrowth intersect in representations of rural disappearance.

Whose Heritage? Slovak Pastoralists in UNESCO's Nomination Process

Miss Paulína Blahová (Slovak Academy of Sciences)

Focusing on Slovakia, this research examines the UNESCO nomination of transhumance as both living heritage and a representation of disappearing rural life. It explores how values of nature are attached to pastoral practices, and how herders' knowledge is translated or silenced.

P43 · O-201

Boundaries and crossings in Asian folk narratives of the "natural" environment

O-201: Sun 14 Jun 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Prof Sowparnika Balaswaminathan (Concordia University, Montreal); Dr Kedar Kulkarni (FLAME University) [\[FNLM\]](#)

This panel explores the boundaries and crossings found in folk narratives of the "natural" environment in anthropocene Asia through film, literature and other media. We emphasize interdisciplinary approaches that entangle disparate religious and cultural formations, and challenge fixed identities.

Folklore and Faith: Goddess of Rice's Lessons for Sustainability and Social Harmony

Ms Widyarini Susilo Putri (University of Limerick)

The Goddess of Rice, Dewi Sri, in East Java, Indonesia, embodies a blend of folklore and religious ethics. They teach sustainable food practices, gratitude, and strengthen community harmony, aligning with the United Nations SDGs 12 and 16.

A Pedagogy of Forms: Mudi yettu and Mohiniyattam

Dr Kedar Kulkarni (FLAME University)

In this paper, I explore the conceptual and institutional boundaries between Mudi yettu, a folk theatre, and Mohiniyattam, a classical dance tradition, both from Kerala, India. Such a juxtaposition makes visible the crossings—between ritual and art, village and stage, nature and institution.

Myth in Motion: Aqueous Transformation of Folklore and Labour in Amitav Ghosh's Gun Island

Miss Sudeshna Ghosh (Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati)

Myths do not simply travel; they transform. In Gun Island, Amitav Ghosh traces how folklores from the Sundarbans in Bengal resurface in Venice and the Mediterranean. The paper presents myth as a hydromorphic form shaped by

water's material form and sustained through wet labour.

Spirited Rebellion: Folk Narratives and Land Politics in South Indian Regional Cinema

Prof Sowparnika Balaswaminathan (Concordia University, Montreal)

In this paper I examine two South Indian cinematic explorations of folk narratives that instrumentalize the boundary-crossing abilities of their respective protagonists to interrogate contemporary political questions of land sovereignty of tribal and rural communities.

P44 · A-301

Mythical nature(s) and narrative transformations across the North Atlantic Panel

A-301: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Ingibjörg Ágústs dóttir (University of Iceland)

This panel explores North Atlantic narratives that draw on myth, nature, and folklore to reflect on identity, memory, and ecology. It invites papers on how figures like selkies or sea spirits express trauma, resistance, and alternative worldviews across diverse northern landscapes.

Monsters and guardian spirits: nature, memory and cultural identity in Icelandic fiction of the Allied occupation

Dr Daisy Neijmann (University of Iceland)

This paper will discuss the use of mythological creatures in Icelandic fiction of the occupation during World War II to express emotions of trauma, loss and uncertainty as well as hope of protection through shared cultural memory and a deeply rooted connection with the natural landscape.

Celestial Wives: The Mari between the Indigenous and Soviet

Dr Lioudmila Fedorova (Georgetown University)

This paper explores how Osokin's "Celestial Wives of the Meadow Mari" and Fedorchenko's film adaptation blend Soviet history into mythological time. By reimagining Mari folklore of women's relationships with nature, they seek to reclaim Mari identity beyond the trauma of colonization.

Rusalka, Witch, or Proud Woman: Yelena Andreyevna's Power, Enchantments, and Sorrows in Chekhov's Uncle Vanya

Mrs Rebekka Thrainsdóttir (University of Iceland)

Yelena Andreyevna, in Uncle Vanya by Chekhov, is likened to Rusalka (a water nymph) and a witch who enchants people and clouds their judgment. Yet, Yelena is a proud, benevolent woman who longs to be free from the everyday monotony and boredom. Is she truly a Rusalka, or simply a bored woman?

Better Dead than in Denmark: Folk Legends of Thwarted Attempts to Ship Icelandic Poet Guðmundur Bergþórsson (1657 - 1705) from Snæfellsnes to King Frederick IV's Court

Ms Alice Bower (University of Iceland)

A narrative analysis contextualising two variants of a 19th century Icelandic folk legend telling of historical poet Guðmundur Bergþórsson's magical resistance to a threat of forced relocation to King Frederick IV's court.

P45 · O-206

Transformations of narrative knowledge in the Arctic and sub-Arctic, and the ongoing degradation of sentient landscapes in the North Panel

O-206: Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45

Convenors: Dr Tatiana Argounova-Low (University of Aberdeen); Dr Csaba Mészáros (ELTE, Research Centre for the Humanities); Dr Kyunney Takasaeva (University of Warsaw (Poland))

The panel invites researchers for collaborative exploration of traditional and contemporary forms of storytelling about ongoing ecological degradation, precarity of traditional lifestyles, adaptations, and visions of the future in the (sub)-Arctic emerging through narratives and narrative objects.

From Clan Legends to Horror Movies: The Transformations of Narratives About Meadows in Subarctic Yakutia.

Dr Csaba Mészáros (ELTE, Research Centre for the Humanities)

By examining the changing narrative representations of meadows in Yakutia, this paper demonstrates how permafrost landscapes are equally exposed to ecological and climatic changes, as well as to an emerging polyphonic ontological context, which has distanced them from the local community.

Narratives captured in Ice: contemporary ice carving and storytelling in Sakha Sire

Dr Tatiana Argounova-Low (University of Aberdeen); Dr Kyunney Takasaeva (University of Warsaw (Poland))

Ice carving is a form of contemporary art in Sakha Sire. Popularity of ice carving is driven by availability, accessibility, and affordability of material. Ice is flexible. We analyse prevalent narratives presented in contemporary ice carvings: mythology, history, politics, environmental concerns.

P46 · O-202

Listening for (un)natural contexts in audio recordings of folk narratives Panel

O-202: Sun 14 Jun 16:00-17:45

Convenors: Ms Madi Becker (Indiana University); Mr Benjamin Storsved (Indiana University); Mr Connor Toole (Indiana University)

This panel explores the ways in which the use of audio recording devices to record folk narratives produce a “natural,” “induced natural,” or “unnatural” performance environment. We present case studies from Tanzania, Scotland, Ireland, Kyrgyzstan, and the United States to address this theme.

Speaking, singing, recording, and transcribing across time with archival recordings

Ms Monica Marion (Indiana University)

Recorded archival stories collapse time, so a listener experiences both closeness and distance from the performance. Comparing versions of the “Gifts of the Little People” across Ireland and Scotland highlights how storytellers, transcribers, and audiences navigate “naturalness” in an old story.

Vernacular theory and the history of audio-recorded Kyrgyz epic poems

Mr Benjamin Storsved (Indiana University)

Attitudes of Kyrgyz epic singers to audio recording technology and its impact on their performances and the afterlives of their voices has historically varied. Their negative or positive interpretations of this technology provide insights into the possibilities for the reception of such recordings.

Memory, Fair Days, and Faction Fights: A Study of Violence in the Irish Folklore Collection

Mr Connor Toole (Indiana University)

This presentation examines anecdotes concerning faction fights in Ireland. A faction fight is a brawl between two groups intended for recreation or to settle disputes. It questions what similarities and differences exist between faction fights and why this motif endures in Irish folklore studies.

Private Songs, Public Voices: Recording Contexts in the Gàidhealtachd

Ms Madi Becker (Indiana University)

Recordings of Calum Ruadh, crofter and bard of Skye, reveal how land and livelihood shaped his identity and songs. Archival contexts have reframed these as national heritage, showing how “natural” lives and environments can be transformed by recording and preservation.

The Role of Listening in Narrating Difficult and Intimate Experiences in “Natural” and Ethnographic Environments

Dr Jelena Marković (Institute of ethnology and folklore research)

By reflecting on listening as labour, as error, and listening out, access is enabled to unspoken, intimate, or traumatic narratives, fostering recognition, dialogue, and reciprocal understanding. In this paper, listening is questioned as the final destination of narratives in different settings.

P47 · O-206

Risking it all: disaster narratives, identity, and fierce nature Panel

O-206: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15

Convenors: Mr Áki Guðni Karlsson (University of Iceland); Ms Amy Skillman (Goucher College)

To brave the elements or be caught in a natural disaster: to outrun the wildfires or the flood; to be caught in a storm, in the mountains or out at sea, make a narrow escape and live to tell the tale. We explore disaster narratives, tales of life-threatening situations and fierce nature.

Unnatural Disaster: Griffith, Salgari and Alternative Narratives of Risk

Prof EMANUELA ETTORRE (University G. d'Annunzio)

Exploring unnatural disaster in George Griffith's (1898) and Emilio Salgari's (1907) turn-of-the-twentieth-century tales, this paper contrasts a British dystopian warning against capitalist hubris with an Italian ambivalent fantasy of technological mastery.

Natural Spaces under the Challenge of Dystopian Speculative Fiction

Ms Valérie Stiénon (Sorbonne Paris Nord University)

Speculative literature explores the nature/culture divide and ecological decline. French dystopian novels of the 19th and 20th centuries depict degraded landscapes as signs of crisis, linking entropy and anthropisation, critiquing unchecked ambitions, and hinting at possible future solutions.

Seeking Disaster: The AI-Guided Route to Destroying Humanity and Saving(?) Nature

Mr Accursio Graffeo (University of Turin / University of Zurich / Bruno Kessler Foundation)

Secondary catastrophic narratives unfold from some online transhumanist users: dystopian futures tied to AI and the Singularity, fears of marginalization, salvation through destruction. Nature and climate change emerge as both backdrop and protagonists in hybrid scenarios between real and virtual.

Turkish Legends of Disaster: Confronting Nature and the Supernatural

Other Nagihan Baysal Yurdakul (Ege University Institute of Turkic World Studies)

This study explores how boundary violations between human, nature and the supernatural in the legends of Turkish world link sacred or cursed places, taboos, and rituals to disasters, highlighting their role in shaping identity and ecological memory.

P48 · A-309

Nature and its limits Panel

A-309: Sat 13 Jun 13:15-15:00, 15:30-17:15

Convenors: Mr Carlos Batista (Columbia University); Dr Catherine Fennell (Columbia University)

Discussant: Prof Cymene Howe (Rice University); Prof Andrea Muehlebach (University of Bremen)

This panel explores the narrativization of the rural-urban divide and its mobilization of discussions on the future of "humanity." Discussing the marketization of animals and urbanization processes around the world, the panel is interested in where the urban world "ends" and where nature "begins."

Chimeric nature(s): Exploring the "mountains" of Japan's industrial past

Dr Alina-Alexandra Hara (Independent researcher)

This paper draws on the concept of "chimerism"—a term from the natural sciences denoting an organism with multiple sets of DNA—to examine narratives on Japanese spoil tips. Like genetic chimeras, these narratives mutate, propagate, and fuse, defying binary notions such as "industrial" or "natural".

"Re-naturalization" narratives in late industrial urban America (U.S.)

Dr Catherine Fennell (Columbia University)

This anthropological paper examines how various people come to live and work with the remainders of housing in late industrial urban America (United States). In particular, I consider the narrative practices that render decaying and destroyed housing a "re-naturalized" grounds of engagement.

Unsettling Refuge: Disrupted Mobilities in Multispecies Worlds

Prof Bettina Stoetzer (MIT)

This paper draws on several case studies, including the movements and lives of birds, wild boar and orcas to reflect on the ways in which shifting animal mobilities across urban/rural and national boundaries forge new challenges and pathways for environmental action in an era of climate change.

Living in Tide: Navigating climate in the amphibious city

Dr Nikhil Anand (University of Pennsylvania)

In this paper, I show how for indigenous fishers in Mumbai, climate change is the outcome of a centuries long process materialized by colonial modes of intervening in, and "improving" cities with infrastructures that accrete and desiccate its amphibious volumes.

P49 · O-106

Roots and voices: exploring nature, identity, and the sacred in oral narratives from indigenous communities across cultures and continents. Panel

O-106: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Lauren Hossack (University of Aberdeen); Mrs Helen Nohgwe Yogo (Institute of Sociology, Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz University of Hannover)

Oral traditions from indigenous communities reveal nature, spirituality, and identity converge in storytelling, shaping ecological knowledge, cultural memory, and community resilience amid domination by digital technology, preserving generational wisdom and fostering connection to land and culture.

Thorns of Truth: Rang Rih and the Indigenous Jurisprudence of the Papiackum Sacred Chair **Keywords: Indigenous jurisprudence; oral tradition; sacred ecology; truth & reconciliation; ritual performance**

Mrs Helen Nohgwe Yogo (Institute of Sociology, Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz University of Hannover)

This paper contributes to the panel by showing how Rang Rih, the Papiackum sacred thorned chair, embodies an Indigenous jurisprudence where oral narratives inscribe justice into ecological and ancestral landscapes, resonating with global traditions of nature-rooted truth.

With the Mountain, Not About It: Ritual Performance, Cultural Memory and Sacred Geographies in Lahaul, Western Himalayas

Ms Megha Thakur (Indian Institute of Technology Mandi)

In Lahaul, Western Himalayas, mountains shape the valley's cultural discourse, and the landscape is regarded as kin. In their worldview, ritual performances and oral traditions are living conversations with the land, sustaining ways of dwelling, memory, and cosmological intimacy across generations.

Serahur: The Sacralization of Rice in the Religious Epic of the Teduray and Lambangian of Mindanao

Dr Mary Jane Rodriguez (University of the Philippines, Diliman)

This paper explores how rice as "serahur" fundamentally shapes the Teduray and Lambangian understanding of "being" and "becoming." It examines their unique synthesis of material and spiritual realms through rice-based meaning-making as they pursue their ongoing struggle for self-determination.

P50 · O-202

Eco-possession: Divining natural environments Panel

O-202: Sun 14 Jun 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Mr Lodewyk Barkhuizen (University of Tartu); Ms Silvie Lang (University of Kassel)

Chair: Mr Lodewyk Barkhuizen (University of Tartu); Ms Silvie Lang (University of Kassel)

The panel explores the ability of natural environments to possess and speak through human bodies. We foreground nature as an active, agential force capable of articulating its grief, resistance, and desires, by penetrating and controlling human bodies.

Possession(s) and Belonging(s): Making Space for Human-Nature Composites to Speak Together

Mr Lodewyk Barkhuizen (University of Tartu)

This paper maps out a conceptual space from which to articulate the notion of eco-possession in terms of the dynamics between vulnerability, belonging, and mutual care.

When Mountains Clap and Stones Cry Out: Eco-Possession in Biblical Narratives

Ms Silvie Lang (University of Kassel)

This paper explores biblical narratives where nature speaks and acts—mountains clap, stones cry out, creation groans—as early accounts of eco-possession, revealing how natural environments assert agency within human consciousness and culture.

Possessed by Wind: Emily Brontë and Transcorporeality

Dr Krista Lysack (King's University College at the University of Western Ontario)

With reference to Emily Brontë's (1818-48) writing about wind, this paper explores eco-possession as a permeability between human and non-human forms in light of Stacy Alaimo's concept of 'transcorporeality' (2010) and Astrida Neimanis's (2017) notion of 'weathering' bodies.

Aquatic Resonances: Water as Agent of Destratification and Ecological Ethics in English Fairy Tales

Dr Davood Khazaie (Hamburg-based Remote Fellow at SUCCLS (Shiraz University))

Water in Jacobs' English Fairy Tales is no backdrop but an agent of destratification. Across four tales, seas, wells, and moats dismantle human hierarchies of class, morality, and identity, enforcing an ecological fatalism where order arises only through submission to nonhuman logic.

P51 · A-311

“Our” natures, “their” natures: How contemporary legend delineates, defines, and describes us Panel

A-311: Sun 14 Jun 11:15-13:00, 16:00-17:45

Convenors: Dr Ian Brodie (Cape Breton University); Other Jakob Löfgren (); Ms Sofia Wanström (Åbo Akademi University)

Contemporary legend addresses the worldview of the group, by challenging the institutional knowledges “they” have encouraged and/or building on the biases and perspectives “we” maintain despite them. This panel explores the ongoing social relevance of the most modern of vernacular folk genres.

Us and Them: Legend as a Study in Contrast

Dr Ian Brodie (Cape Breton University)

As an intimate genre, legend anticipates a relationship between teller and listener thicker than that between both teller and listener and a third party, whether that be a character within the account or an imagined other, who interprets the utterance otherwise. In contrasts, our nature is explored.

Gender and the Supercrip in American Contemporary Legend

Dr Jeana Jorgensen (Butler University)

Depictions of disability in narrative folklore stereotype and erase, with many representations of disability as a punishment or flaw. Scholars have studied the notion of the supercrip, someone empowered by their disability, as gendered in fairy tale, which this paper extends to contemporary legend.

The western, or a film history of narratives about nature

Dr Carlos Tabernero (Autonomous University of Barcelona)

This paper will offer a historical reading of a range of western film narratives, from the US and beyond, focusing on their narrative and aesthetic conventions and subversions concerning the construction of visual socio-cultural spaces for natural history and the environment.

P52 · A-303

Talking tables: food, stories, and social encounters Panel

A-303: Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Ms Vilborg Bjarkadóttir (University of Iceland); Miss Rakel Jónsdóttir (Independent researcher); Mr Janis Sabanovs (Rīga Stradiņš University); Mrs Auður Viðarsdóttir (Háskóli Íslands); Miss Sigrún Hanna Þorgrímsdóttir (University of Iceland)

Chair: Miss Rakel Jónsdóttir (Independent researcher); Miss Sigrún Hanna Þorgrímsdóttir (University of Iceland)

Tables are more than surfaces, they are active, symbolic spaces of commensality. This panel explores how food, materiality, and storytelling entangle at the table, transforming nature into culture and shaping social meanings through shared meals.

The Table as Archive: Marine Species, Memory and Ecological Entanglement in the Post-Resettlement Boat Dwelling Community

Ms Hanqing Zhang (University College London)

Drawing on the fieldwork in northeast Fujian, China, this research examines how former boat dwellers maintain ecological bonds with marine species after resettlement. Stories about yellow croakers, clams and oysters at changing tables reveal how relocation reconfigures multispecies relationships.

Mountain of Flour, Streams of Milk: Food memories and nostalgia around the kitchen table.

Miss Rakel Jónsdóttir (Independent researcher)

This paper explores childhood food memories as reflections of nostalgia, identity, and intergenerational connection. It examines how these memories shape cultural belonging and whether nostalgia can inspire sustainable cooking practices, challenging consumerism and the decline of home cooked meals.

Welcome to the Living Room

Miss Siyu Li (Justus-Liebig-University Giessen)

Based on my food installation, the paper presents a social encounter that reimagines the living room as a shared ecological commons. Through tasting as a method of inquiry into forgotten flavors and vernacular knowledge, this research explores how governmentality shapes what counts as edible.

Rescued Recipes, Cooking Traps, Reeducation for Husbands, and a Very Ugly Glove. Global Narratives from the Common Kitchen.

Prof Francisco Cruces Villalobos (Universidad Nacional de Educación a Distancia)

In the storytelling during collaborative workshops about the social life of kitchens, “Nature” provides just a background. Other main characters lead the plot: disputed gender roles, strong emotions, senses of belonging, the duty to feed, and the moral economies and poetics of modern home.

The Table as Teacher: Oikonomia, commensality and a Pedagogy of Creative Sustainability

Miss Sigrún Hanna Þorgrímsdóttir (University of Iceland)

This paper explores the performative role of the table and commensality in enacting sustainability as oikonomia, developing a pedagogy for Creative Sustainability that fosters relational care, ecological awareness, and collective learning.

Winter Solstice Folk Ritual Lore: Stories of Observing Nature and Creating Fantasy

Dr Fumihiko Kobayashi (Independent Scholar)

This paper explores the East Asian winter solstice custom of eating red-bean porridge. This commensal act transforms a food into a cultural symbol, telling a story of communal survival against disease by blending astute natural observation with protective folklore.

P55 · A-201

Southern Gothic forms in literature of the Celtic and Nordic peripheries Panel

A-201: Sun 14 Jun 16:00-17:45

Convenors: Dr Haukur Ingvarsson (University of Iceland); Prof Jenna Grace Sciuto (Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts)

Centering the grotesque and transgressive aesthetics of the southern gothic, this panel considers the gothic's role in literature from the Celtic&Nordic peripheries in elucidating what is suppressed in narratives of national histories and normative identities and what reappears in supernatural ways.

Landscapes of Loss, Transcripts of Trauma? Reading Scotland's Viking Namescapes as Southern Gothic Narratives

Dr Alan Macniven (The University of Edinburgh)

This paper will use a southern gothic lens to review the evidence for Norse settlement in the Western Isles of Scotland. The presence and absence of tropes in local namescapes are used to look behind sanitised narratives, to expose forgotten societal trauma and centre the fate of suppressed groups.

Contrasting Fantasies of the Future and the Past in the poetry of Einar Benediktsson (1864-1940)

Dr Haukur Ingvarsson (University of Iceland)

The poetry of Einar Benediktsson (1864-1940) incorporates contrasting fantasies of future and past. This lecture explores how ghostly motifs in his work reflect tensions between modernity and history in Icelandic context, drawing parallels to societal trauma as seen in Southern Gothic literature.

Tracing Queer Space and Southern Gothic Forms in Two Icelandic Novels

Prof Jenna Grace Sciuto (Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts)

Applying US southern gothic forms to two novels set in Iceland in 1918—Sjón's *Moonstone: The Boy Who Never Was* (2013) and Gunnar Gunnarsson's *Seven Days of Darkness* (1920)—brings repressed societal aspects, such as the suppression of queerness in Icelandic nationalist discourses, to the surface.

Houses Afire: Nordic and Southern Gothic in Absalom, Absalom! and The Saga of Burnt Njál

Dr Taylor Hagood (Florida Atlantic University)

This presentation explores the parallels between *Absalom, Absalom!* and *The Saga of Burnt Njál*, paying particular attention to shared Gothic elements, including quasi-hauntings and curses, and the interconnections of family, violence, justice, and community.

P58 · A-304

Exploring digitalised folkloric youth political activism in new geographies of the global South Panel

A-304: Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Abdelaziz El Bakkali (USMBA, Fés, Morocco---- ASU, USA); Prof Elhassane El Hilali (LALITRA Research Laboratory, Mohammedia, Hassan II University)

Given the specificities of the youth context, understanding the dynamics of youth subcultures is crucial to understanding alternative cultures in politics of changing patterns of political participation, within meanings related to young people's digital experiences in new geographies

Whispers in the Feed: Gendered Silences and Folkloric Resistance in Moroccan Digital

Miss Hafssa Chahbane (Sidi Mohamed Ben Abdellah University - FLDM)

This paper examines the way Moroccan youth, especially women, transform silence into digital folklore. Through veiled critique, coded symbols, fragmented narratives, and strategic ambiguity, silence becomes a powerful mode of activism, reshaping political expression in the Global South.

Redefining Political Communication through Social Networks: Moroccan Youth and Digital Counter-Discourse

Mr Elhoucine Boualili (Sidi Mohamed Ben Abdellah University, Faculty of Letters and Human Sciences, Dhar EL Mahraz, Fez); Dr Abdelaziz El Bakkali (USMBA, Fés, Morocco---- ASU, USA); Prof Elhassane El Hilali (LALITRA Research Laboratory, Mohammedia, Hassan II University)

Moroccan youth use digital activism to resist hegemonic discourses, counter portrayals of disengagement, and create alternative narratives. Drawing on Castells' counter-power theory, this study of 20 youth shows how online strategies reshape participation, amplify voices, and influence opinion.

Constructing Environmental Narratives in Digital Media: Internet Memes and Youth Digital Activism in Serbia

Dr Ana Banić Grubišić (University of Belgrade)

This paper explores how Serbian youth use internet memes to shape environmental narratives and activism. Through digital ethnography (2018 - present), it analyzes memes on hydropower and lithium protests, revealing critiques of extractive capitalism and visions of ecological justice.

P61 · O-201

Plants and Gardens

O-201: Sun 14 Jun 16:00-17:45

Convenors: Prof Anne Duggan (Wayne State University)

[FNLM]

This FNLM panel explores real and figurative plants and gardens and their connections to metamorphosis in different types of fairy-tale texts in ways that challenge human/non-human dichotomies.

“Pluck His Flower”: Male Vegetal Transformation and Gendered Nature in the French Fairy Tale Tradition (under the FNLM committee)

Mrs Fanny Alice Marchaisse (Northwestern University)

This paper examines male vegetal metamorphosis in late 17th-century French fairy tales by women. By transforming princes into trees and flowers, these contes invert classical tropes, rendering masculinity passive and decorative, and staging a queer ecology of enchantment and power.

When the Sakura Tree Falls: Rewilding Cinderella Through Absence in Akumi Agitogi's 'My Happy Marriage'

Miss Sarah Jessica Darley (University of East Anglia)

Applying Joanna Gilar's 'Rewilding Cinderella' model to 'My Happy Marriage' (2019-present), this paper will explore the absence — of nature, hope, and the sakura (cherry blossom) tree — within Akumi Agitogi's light novels, manga (2022-present), and anime series (2022-5).

Plant-Human Entanglements in the Japanese Fairy Tale “Melon Princess” (for FNLM committee)

Dr Mayako Murai (); Ms Kim Pace (Camberwell College of Arts)

This presentation, accompanied by a filmed visual sequence inspired by kamishibai, reinterprets Japanese fairy tale “Melon Princess” by shifting focus from the human-centred plot to the way the tale intertwines the lives of various kinds of plants with those of other natural and supernatural beings.

P62 · O-201

Media and Senses

O-201: Tue 16 Jun 16:15-18:00

Convenors: Mrs Fanny Alice Marchaisse (Northwestern University)

[FNLM]

From literary fairy tales to visual and digital adaptations, this FNLM panel explores how imagination, perception, and embodiment inform storytelling and human engagement with the world.

“Can we use our imaginations to change our nature? Holism versus Dualism in the Literary Fairy Tales of the Countess de Murat (1668-1716)”

Dr Allison Stedman (University of North Carolina - Charlotte)

This paper will explore how late 17th-century French fairy tale writers engaged with a controversial and pressing socio-intellectual question of the time: the degree to which a person's thoughts could affect the material nature of their bodies, and potentially the nature of the world around them.

“Cultivating One's Garden in Sébastien Laudenbach's The Girl without Hands.”

Prof Anne Duggan (Wayne State University)

This paper brings together disability studies and ecocriticism to illuminate how Sébastien Laudenbach's 2016 filmic adaptation of the Grimms' "Maiden without Hands" engages us to think about disability and the environment in ways that empower the heroine.

"Elemental Entanglements: Sensory Ecologies in E.T.A. Hoffmann's "The Mines of Falun" and Natalie Frank's Visual Narrative"

Prof Melissa King (Berry College)

This paper explores the entanglement of narrative and nature through the lens of sensory ecology, focusing on E.T.A. Hoffmann's "The Mines of Falun" and its illustrated adaptation by artist Natalie Frank, whose synesthetically-informed paintings destabilize a whole host of binary distinctions.

P63 · A-311

Supernatural Beings Panel

A-311: Tue 16 Jun 16:15-18:00

Convenors: Prof Alf Arvidsson (Umeå University); Ms Sofia Silvén (University of Turku)

Chair: Prof Alf Arvidsson (Umeå University); Ms Sofia Silvén (University of Turku)

Individual papers on supernatural beings

Claws, Cliffs, Wings, and Water: thoughts on the taloned griffin in-tale in the 'Conall Gulban' story.

Dr Síle de Cléir (University of Limerick)

This paper explores the in-tale of the griffin in the 'Conall Gulban' story. This is a humorous interlude in an otherwise intense and violent narrative. It portrays both nature and quasi-magical beings in a comical way, broadening our understanding of the role of the natural world in folktales.

The Ways of Water: Talking about Otherness and Liminality in Welsh Narrative Traditions

Dr Angelika Heike Rüdiger (PMH-School)

Water, as an ambiguous element, relates to the Welsh narrative traditions of the Tylwyth Teg. Water-related motifs describe otherness and liminality. In social discourse, these motifs are projected onto marginalized or foreign groups. Evidence is provided from folklore collections and literature.

The Linguistic Representation of the Changeling Belief in the Slovak Šariš Dialect Discourse

Dr Miroslava Gavurová (Faculty of Arts, University of Prešov)

The paper analyses linguistic representations and discursive strategies expressing the unfounded belief in changelings in the Šariš dialects of Slovak, comparing them with motifs in other traditions, and examines how such culturally embedded beliefs are reinforced and transmitted.

The Vernacular Lucifer: Narrating the Harvesting of Light in Late Modernity

Ms Sofia Silvén (University of Turku)

This paper investigates narratives used in the societal discourse relating to the electrification of society and harnessing of light for human use. It inspects counter-narratives of the Christian figure Lucifer, who in late modernity was known as light bringer as well as the devil.

Experience and doubt: archival recordings making sense of encounters with "vittra"

Prof Alf Arvidsson (Umeå University)

In interviews from northern Sweden 1955-1980, people went a long way in discussing personal experiences of encounters with vittra (fairies). Their reasoning, explanation and rhetorical strategies in negotiating traditional knowledge and modernity's rationality will be examined in this presentation.

P64 · O-201

Nature, gender, and love

O-201: Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45

Convenors: Prof Jill Terry Rudy (Brigham Young University)

[FNLM]

How Myth and Place Reinforce Romanticization and Obfuscation: The Case of Arethusa

This paper explores how the myth of Alpheus and Arethusa and the Fonte Arethusa site mutually reinforce one another through romanticization and obfuscation, offering a case study of how nature narratives shape cultural memory, tourism, and perceptions of the past.

Prof Jill Terry Rudy (Brigham Young University)

From Fairy Tales to The Outermost House to Maine Farm Country: Seeking Nature with Writings of Henry Beston and Elizabeth Coatsworth

Nature's rhythms, fairy storytellers, and writers' craft provoke the family life of partners Henry Beston and Elizabeth Coatsworth. World travel and quotidian observation mark their creations from the Firelight Fairy Book and The Outermost House to The Cat Who Went to Heaven and Personal Geography.

Dr Elizabeth Howard ()

The Melancholy Merman: Gender, Nature, and Eroticism in Helena Nyblom's "Agneta and the Sea King" (1910)

This paper examines how the supernatural figure of the sea king, in Swedish author Helena Nyblom's 1910 fairy tale, "Agneta and the Sea King," complicates traditional gender dynamics and offers an ecocritical critique of human dominance of the natural world. [Please consider this paper for FNLM]

P65 · O-106

Post-conflicts Panel

O-106: Sun 14 Jun 09:00-10:45

Convenors: Dr Reana Senjković (Institute of Ethnology and Folklore Research)

Individual papers on post-conflicts

Google Maps' reviews of Hiroshima's Japanese gardens: Tracing small digital stories eighty years after the Atomic Bomb

Prof Chaim Noy ()

The paper analyzes brief digital narratives that users share when reviewing Japanese gardens on Google Maps. Stories address issues of remains and survival of nature vis-à-vis the supernatural/non-natural catastrophe of war & atomic bombing. A hybrid genre emerges, combining multiple materialities.

"The Cliff Was Ordered to Disappear": Narratives of Mastering Nature in Postwar Yugoslavia

Dr Reana Senjković (Institute of Ethnology and Folklore Research)

After WWII, countries that adopted socialism paired reconstruction with the idea of a "new man." Its strongest realization was success in the struggle against nature's forces. I will illustrate this through newspaper and literary narratives on youth labor brigades in the socialist Yugoslavia (SFRY).

Survival Naturescapes: Life Stories of Greek Childhoods during WWII

Other Chryssi Grapsa (National and Kapodistrian University of Athens); Mrs Rea Kakampoura (National and Kapodistrian University of Athens)

Life stories of Greeks who were children during WWII reveal how forests and landscapes shaped survival, memory, and identity, forming "naturescapes" where personal and collective wartime experiences intertwine.

Meandering Narratives of the "Green Border": Remembering and Reimagining the Iron Curtain through Nature

Dr Michal Pavlásek (Czech Academy of Sciences)

At the Czech-Austrian border, the overgrowth of the former Iron Curtain within Podyjí National Park creates a “mnemonic ecology,” where ruins of guard posts, conservation practices, and human-nonhuman narratives intertwine, transforming dark heritage into a layered landscape of recovery.

P66 · O-202

Technology – old and new Panel

O-202: Tue 16 Jun 16:15-18:00

Convenors: Dr Anne Sigrid Refsum (University of Bergen)

Individual papers on technology

Runosong Landscapes: Mapping Trees in Finnic Oral Poetry

Dr Kati Kallio (Finnish Literature Society); Dr Anneli Poska (Taltech); Dr Mari Väina (Estonian Literary Museum)

On the basis of folklore and vegetation history data, this transdisciplinary study explores connections between surrounding nature and cultural expression, to highlight how oral poetry encodes and transmits environmental knowledge across time and space.

Is This Norway? Place and Landscape in Folktales of Norwegian Tradition and LLM Generation

Dr Anne Sigrid Refsum (University of Bergen)

How do references to place and landscape constitute 'Norwegianness' in folktales? Part of the ERC project AI STORIES, this paper explores and compares nature and culture in Norwegian traditional folktales and in LLM generated 'Norwegian' folktale-like narratives.

Barbed Wire and the Violence of the Nature-Culture Divide: Myth, Modernity, and the Making of the Wild West

Dr Boštjan Nedoh (ZRC SAZU)

This paper argues that the invention and rapid spread of barbed wire in the United States in the late nineteenth century provides a paradigmatic example of the violence embedded in the nature-culture divide.

Engaging Myth and Folklore for Design Education

Dr Karl Aspelund (University of Rhode Island)

Design education's technological worldview frames nature simply as raw resources. We must instead empower designers to be stewards of our planet's riches. I propose integrating myth and folklore in design studies to foster reverence for our environment and inspire authentic regenerative practices.

Engaging with Folktales as Technology for Emotional and Social Healing

Mr Cristopher Anderson (Cris Anderson Productions, Inc.)

Folktales might be old maps for ceremonies – a report from 34 years of field research engaging with folktales ceremonially via audience-as-artist theater participation to reconcile emotional, social and spiritual dilemmas, and return individuals and communities to healthful equilibrium.

P68 · A-309

Urban landscape and transdisciplinary econarratives Panel

A-309: Sun 14 Jun 16:00-17:45

Convenors: Dr Akemi Kaneshiro-Hauptmann (Toyama Prefectural University); Mrs Holly Winter-Hughes (University of Birmingham)

Individual papers on urban landscape and transdisciplinary econarratives

Exploring nature and well-being through written narratives about urban gardening

Dr Akemi Kaneshiro-Hauptmann (Toyama Prefectural University)

Focusing on narratives in both online and print media, this study examines what constitutes happiness through narratives related to urban gardens and discusses the characteristics of depictions concerning the healing power of plants and nature and the associated sense of well-being.

The Multilayered Narrative of the Croatian Fairy Tale "Stekljena gora" (Glass Mountain): The Natural World between the Universal and the Local

Dr Lidija Bajuk (Institute of Ethnology and Folklore Research); Ms Lea Šprajc (University of Zagreb); Prof Jelka Vince Pallua (Institute of Social Sciences Ivo Pilar, Zagreb)

Analyzing a North Croatian fairy tale "Stekljena gora" (Glass Mountain) and its variants, the paper explores narrative structures symbolically tied to nature. This foundation is both universal and more closely connected to the locality

where it was recorded.

Voices in the Concrete: Bird Calls and Narrative Soundscapes in the City

Mrs Holly Winter-Hughes (University of Birmingham)

This paper explores how bird calls shape urban storytelling, layering memory, emotion and place, and contributing to the evolving narratives of city life through sound and imagination.

Elemental Worldings in Latvian Folklore: Employing Situated Knowledges for Future Ethicalities

Dr Anne Sauka (University of Latvia)

I explore elemental worldings in Latvian folklore in the context of ecophenomenology and critical genealogy. In the article I demonstrate situated knowledges as part of the lived, experiential genealogies that co-constitute us today and consider their significance for reconnecting with the Earth.

Eco-narratives of the 21st Century: Posthuman(ist) Monsters and Eco-feminist Princesses

Dr Patrycja Barbara Pichnicka-Trivedi (University of Warsaw)

The paper analyses ecological tropes in 21st-century vampire narratives and Disney fairy tales from Disney Princess franchise. While both started as modern narratives of man's conquest of the "nature", they evolved to produce stories of Hero-Monsters and Eco-Warrior Princesses.

P69 · A-201

Personal narratives Panel

A-201: Mon 15 Jun 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Catie Gressier (University of Western Australia)

Chair: Dr Catie Gressier (University of Western Australia)

Individual papers on personal narrative

Family Narrative, Experiential Belief and the Supernatural in the United States

Dr Leah Lowthorp (University of Oregon)

This paper explores how everyday supernatural experiences in the United States inspired a family narrative tradition that reaffirms belief of the tellers and fosters belief in succeeding generations. It proposes extending David Hufford's experiential theory of belief to include memorate listeners.

Narratives of Psychedelic-Induced Psychological Transformation in a Naturalistic Scottish Sample

Dr Sofia De La Fuente Garcia (University of Edinburgh)

This paper analyses 115 Scottish psychedelic user narratives of psychological transformation. Many described growth, insight and connection - but others spoke of underwhelm, trauma, or cultural estrangement - pointing to the difficulty of integrating a new sense of self in an unchanged social world.

High street butchery in Australia: tales from a disappearing trade

Dr Catie Gressier (University of Western Australia)

The butchery trade in Australia is disappearing. Through the personal narrative of a retired Perth butcher, I explore what social im/perceptibility can reveal about class, community and human-animal relations in the transformation of the meat processing industry.

Exploring Metaphor, Memory, and Ecological Knowledge through Garhwali Women's folktales

Dr Shivani Bhatt (Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan College, GGSIPU)

This paper explores Garhwali women's folktales, where ripening kafal (bayberry) and cuckoo songs express grief, and ecological knowledge. Through sensory metaphors, these narratives trace human-nature entanglements, preserving memory and revealing how folk speech shapes cultural understanding.

P70 · V-007

Folk fears and nature's fury - fictions, film, flora, and fauna Panel

V-007: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr James Deutsch (Smithsonian Institution); Miss Projita Giri (); Dr Debolina Nath (Kanchrapara College)

From the fear of Nature, not only comes reverence but also the desire to conquer that fear. This panel will explore how nature is simultaneously worshipped and feared, examining how nature symbolizes both reverence and terror across cultural traditions and Folk Narratives.

Cursed Trees in the Narratives of the Ukrainian Carpathians: Retaining, Transmitting, and Stopping Curses

Dr Elena Boudovskaia (Georgetown University)

Carpathian folklore portrays trees as agents of magic: they may house spirits, hold or transmit curses, or protect the living. Through rituals and stories, trees emerge as long-lived beings capable of absorbing, retaining, and redirecting supernatural power.

Ghostly Guides: Haunting in the Indigenous Literature of Tommy Orange and Richard Wagamese

Ms Dianne McPhelim (Dundalk Institute of Technology)

Investigating the indigenously authored novels *There There* (2018) by Tommy Orange and *Indian Horse* (2012) by Richard Wagamese, this paper depicts the inherited dislocation of identity through the symbolic use of ghosts as mechanisms to access ancestral memory and portray cultural haunting.

The Nature of Fantasy: the Ecological Imaginary in an Age of Climate Crisis

Dr Kevan Manwaring (Arts University Bournemouth)

Fantasy has long helped us perceive the world anew. In a time of Climate Emergency is the nature of Fantasy changing to reflect the challenges it presents? Can the blue-sky thinking of the Fantastic provide us with useful tools for addressing 'the defining crisis of our time' (UN)?

"Parks, trees, animals in the modern city. Their transformation into 'sources of fear' within contemporary urban legends (Athens, Greece).

Prof Georgios Kouzas (National and Kapodistrian University of Athens)

This paper examines how nature (environment and animal) becomes a source of fear in contemporary urban legends. While traditionally linked to rural folktales, similar patterns emerge in the city, where parks function as symbolic forests and urban animals (large birds or feral cats) evoke fear.

P71 · O-206

Sacred spaces Panel

O-206: Tue 16 Jun 11:15-13:00, 16:15-18:00

Convenors: Dr Pallabi Borah (Gauhati University); Dr Mridusmita Mahanta (Sonapur College (Autonomous))

Individual papers on sacred spaces

When Śaṅkaradeva brought down Ākāshigangā: Intersection of a Water Body and Making of a Saint

Miss Sushobhita Talukdar (University of Delhi)

This abstract will seek to study miraculous deeds in the context of the space of Ākāshigangā, the story associated with it which has been narrated in the caritas (hagiographies) and by the community over the years, and the making of Śaṅkaradeva.

Myths on the Move: The Brahmaputra as a Narrative of Nature and Culture

Dr Pallabi Borah (Gauhati University)

This paper attempts to interpret how the narratives associated with the river Brahmaputra and its tributaries reverberate the folklore, culture and ethos of people living in the Brahmaputra valley of Assam in Northeast India.

Raga in Rameshwaram: Narrative, Sacred Geography, and Pilgrimage Among Chennai-based Punjabi Sikhs

Dr Amanda Greenbaum (The Ohio State University)

Sikhs' travels to Rameshwaram, one of India's most significant pilgrimage sites, reveals intersections of narrative and place that position them at the center rather than periphery of Sikh tradition.

Nature as Technology: Kurichyan Geomyths and the Making of Landscapes in Wayanad, Kerala, India

Dr Haseena Naji (Vellore Institute of Technology, Chennai)

Kurichyan geomyths from Wayanad, Kerala, India present nature as technology. Through acts of seeding, diverting, and knotting, landscapes become corridors, shrines, and commons- stories that encode ecological techniques and cultural memory.

The Story of the Local God in the Mangrove Forest: Is the Story Being Restored in Bangladesh?

Dr MD ROWSHON JAHID JAHID (University of Rajshahi)

Sundarbans in Bangladesh, fishermen, wood collectors, honey hunters, and other forest workers bid farewell to their families each time they head into the forest, fearing they may not return. During these farewells, they often perform to appease the local forest god, 'Gazi Pir.'

P72 · A-311

Folk song and music Panel

A-311: Mon 15 Jun 09:00-10:45

Convenors: Prof Anđelko Vlašić (Josip Juraj Strossmayer University of Osijek)

Individual papers on folk song and music

Exploring the many lives of Ghumot

Dr SEBANTI Chatterjee (SRM University-AP); Mr Kevin Frank Fernandes (University of Bonn)

This paper situates ghumot, a membranophone percussion instrument from Goa, in the discourse of heritage making. Using an ethnographic approach, we intend to understand how the community participates in the ritualistic and digital storytelling about a musical instrument, culture, and heritage.

"Međimurje, How Beautifully Green You Are": Nature Motifs in the Folk Songs of Međimurje

Ms Janja Kovač (Museum of Međimurje Čakovec); Prof Anđelko Vlašić (Josip Juraj Strossmayer University of Osijek)

The folk songs of the Croatian region of Međimurje, inscribed on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list, preserve rich nature motifs. Despite ecological changes from dense forests to cultivated fields, these symbols remain central to regional identity and cultural representation.

The maiden and the love-leaf: desire and the demonic plant in a Seto folk song

Dr Madis Arukask (University of Tartu)

This presentation deals with a Seto folk song in which a girl who desires a magical plant condemns her home. Although the ideology of the song is patriarchal and moralizing, the song's genesis refers rather to the connection between fertility and death, in which the plant element has symbolic value.

Wild lianas and modest flowers: metaphors, methods, and human relationships

Dr Andreas Kalkun (Estonian Folklore Archives)

In the history of Estonian folklore studies, various metaphors have been used regarding older song traditions. Metaphors taken from nature, especially botanical ones, have been very common. I study the nature metaphors used by Jakob Hurt, Kaarle Krohn, and their contemporaries.

Whistled Identities: Folklore, Spirit, and Cultural Memory in Kongthong

Dr Pallabi Borah (Gauhati University); Ms Krishti Nayana Nath (Kamala Nehru College, Delhi University)

This paper examines the 'Jingrwai Lawbei' as an indigenous practice that links sound, nature, and identity. By analyzing this melodic naming tradition of the people in Kongthong, the study highlights how the practice sustains cultural memory and perpetuates the ethos of an indigenous way of life.

P73 · A-309

Animal-human relations Panel

A-309: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45

Convenors: Ms Mariia Troshchilo ()

Individual papers on animal-human relations

Leveraging Lead: Wildlife, Ammunition, and Border-Thinking

Prof Debra Merskin (board member)

This paper tracks lead ammunition through wildlife, ecosystems, and humans via game meat. Using a Just One Health lens, it becomes clear that human and wildlife health are inextricably linked, entwining hunters, communities, raptors, and environments in complex material and ethical relationships.

Dragons in the Pacific? The life-generating chaos nature of the snake-like creator spirits

Mr Andrus Tins (Estonian Literary Museum/University of Tartu)

Hunters' Narratives in Estonian Folklore as Reflection of Human–Non-Human Entanglement

This presentation provides an overview of Estonian traditional folk narratives about hunters examining their lifestyle, customs, rituals, and relationships with both humans and non-humans. The tales depict the forest as inhabited and moralized space, negotiated with non-human agency.

Ms Mariia Troshchilo ()

Narratives about the Male Emotional Expression: Nature vs Human Beings

In Russian the emotions are often associated with non-man-like behavior, but after closer examination it turns out that a man can be emotional, but in interactions with animals. I will analyze interaction between the men and nature creatures, emotions and their expression in different situations.

Dr Laoise Ni Chleirigh (Maynooth University); Dr Máire Nic an Bhaird (Maynooth University)

Answering the Curlew's Call: Folklore, Biodiversity, and BioCultúr

We explore the curlew's place in Irish folklore and biodiversity decline, linking cultural knowledge, language and ecological loss through the BioCultúr framework. Using co-created graphic literature, we show how oral traditions foster relational, ethical engagement within animal-human relations.

P74 · V-007

Landscapes Panel

V-007: Tue 16 Jun 09:00-10:45, 11:15-13:00

Convenors: Dr Virginia Blankenhorn (University of Edinburgh); Dr Jana Kukaine (); Mr Joshua Lee (University of California, Berkeley)

Individual papers on landscapes

Wind, Calm, and the Sea: Narrating Elemental Entanglements in German Travelogues around 1800

Dr Christina Becher-Tiessen (Goethe University Frankfurt)

The talk explores an elemental poetics of the calm at sea by focusing in particular on the entanglement of humans, animals, and the elemental dimensions of a sea voyage. To this end, I will close-read travelogues written by German-speaking naturalists Adelbert von Chamisso and Georg Forster.

Lost Horizon or Living Landscape? Place, Time and People in Gaelic Tradition

Dr Virginia Blankenhorn (University of Edinburgh)

Stories and songs from the Scottish Studies Archives at Edinburgh University will illustrate the relationship of ordinary Gaels with the lands they inhabited – the people and events that shaped them, the spirits that inhabited them, and the memories taken abroad by those forced to emigrate.

Fannst hann dauður á hrauninu: The place(s) of inhospitable landscapes within the Icelandic legend corpus.

Mr Joshua Lee (University of California, Berkeley)

This paper examines Icelandic set in 'inhospitable' landscapes, assessing the role of these landscapes, e.g. lava-fields, within legend structure, the frequency of different types of inhabitants within these spaces, and the relationship(s) between rural Icelanders and peripheral unproductive lands.

Naturalizing the Other?: The Crossroads of Ethnographic Shows and the Idea of (Natural and Living) Habitat

Dr Dominika Czarnecka (Institute of Archaeology and Ethnology, Polish Academy of Sciences)

A specific logic of a "living" habitat simulating a natural habitat has never been thoroughly analyzed in the context of the Völkerschau. The aim of this presentation is broader inquiry into the relationship between ethnographic shows, the idea of habitat, and the construction of otherness.

Valuing landscapes through stories: an Estonian example

Dr Marju Kõivupuu (Tallinn University)

The present study asks how storytelling practices related to landscapes, sacred sites, and local lore have changed in post-Soviet Estonia.